Bloodlines at the Apex: Executive Gatekeeping, Regime Shocks, and Cross-Party Kinship Insurance in the Bangladesh Parliament and Cabinet (1973–2026)

Full-Length Q1 Journal Manuscript: Formal Theory, Forensic Census Architecture, Multi-Way Clustered Econometrics, and Institutional History ($N = 4,527$ Seat Tenures; 401 Dynastic Profiles; 170 Political Families)

Complete Longitudinal Panel of the 1st–13th Jatiya Sangsads and Executive Cabinets of Bangladesh (1973–2026)

Abstract

Why do hereditary political families not merely survive democratic transitions, military coups, electoral boycotts, and mass revolutions, but systematically tighten their grip as one moves from the parliamentary backbenches to the executive Cabinet? Existing scholarship on political dynasties in comparative politics either examines narrow cross-sectional snapshots [51], restricts attention to major-party candidates in select general elections [56], or relies on qualitative descriptions of leadership succession [4, 60–62]. Using the first complete, forensically audited population census of all $N = 4,527$ Member of Parliament (MP) seat records across all 13 parliaments of Bangladesh from 1973 to 2026—linked to standardized five-tier career Cabinet portfolios and a bidirectional genealogical registry of 401 unique dynastic MPs across 170 political families (`FAM-001` to `FAM-170`)—this study resolves three foundational puzzles in comparative political economy. First, addressing the **Executive Gatekeeping Question (RQ1)**, linear probability and logistic regressions with party and parliament fixed effects—and standard errors clustered at the root-name ($G = 2,190$), exact family/individual ($G = 2,482$: 170 families $+2,312$ non-dynasts), and constituency ($G = 545$) levels—demonstrate that dynastic MPs enjoy a $+24.57$ percentage-point premium in career Cabinet appointment ($t_{\text{fam}} = 7.98$, $p < 0.0001$; adjusted odds ratio $= 3.33$), a $+25.86$ percentage-point premium in Full Cabinet Ministry or Prime Ministerial rank ($t_{\text{fam}} = 7.40$, $p < 0.0001$; odds ratio $= 4.68$), a $+18.91$ percentage-point premium in high-rent sovereign ministries ($t_{\text{fam}} = 5.98$, $p < 0.0001$; 45.42% dynastic share), and a $+17.00$ percentage-point premium ($t = 7.52$, $p < 0.0001$; $+17.41$ pp for Full Ministry, $t = 7.34$) under strictly term-specific governing-coalition portfolio coding. Crucially, the dynastic executive premium is steepest among first-term freshman MPs (41.72% vs. 15.70% for any Cabinet post; 29.58% vs. 7.63% for Full Cabinet Minister, a $3.88\times$ freshman executive fast-track; $+23.81$ pp career and $+16.88$ pp term-specific in freshman-only regressions) and holds significantly inside every historical regime era. Second, addressing **Party, Military-Era, and Regime-Cycle Dynamics (RQ2)**, we show that while the Awami League exhibits the highest legislative dynastic share (26.52%), the BNP (41.56%) and Jatiya Party (39.91%) exhibit even higher executive dynastic concentration; that military governments (Zia and Ershad, 1979–1990) had minimal dynastic presence on the backbenches (3.9%–11.5%) but heavily co-opted traditional dynastic elites into the Cabinet (33.0%–34.7%); and that ruling parties experience a mild *pre-loss dilution* of dynastic share during late-stage overreach followed by a dramatic *post-defeat bunker spike* (51.6% dynastic for AL in 2001; 30.8% for BNP in 1996) when non-dynastic marginal seats collapse. Third, we map generational turnover (where 2nd- and 3rd-generation heirs surpassed 1st-generation founders in the 2014 10th Parliament, reaching 81.5% by the 2026 13th Parliament), personal seat monopolization, the top 7 longest-serving individuals and families, the top 15 stronghold constituencies (led by `Sylhet-1` at 84.6%), and the gendered divergence between custodial widows (9.3% Cabinet rate) and patrilineal daughters (35.5% Cabinet rate).

1 Introduction: The Comparative Puzzle of Dynastic Executive Capture

In comparative political science, the endurance and expansion of hereditary political dynasties inside modern representative regimes constitutes a first-order theoretical anomaly [7, 8, 13, 17, 21, 49]. Classical modernization theory, Weberian bureaucratization, and party institutionalization models long predicted that as mass suffrage deepens, literacy rises, and electoral competition intensifies, ascriptive kinship networks should progressively give way to programmatic party organizations and meritocratic elite selection [37, 40, 48]. Yet empirical research over the past two decades has documented that hereditary

political power is not an archaic residue of pre-democratic agrarian hierarchy; rather, electoral competition itself frequently reproduces and amplifies dynastic advantage across institutional contexts as diverse as the United States [12, 17, 19], Japan [5, 57], the United Kingdom and Western Europe [20, 23, 63], Argentina [54], the Philippines [39, 50, 59], Pakistan [3, 14, 38], and India [11, 13, 15, 22].

Nowhere in the modern world has the fusion of dynastic lineage and state power been more structurally decisive than in Bangladesh. Across the 35 years following the restoration of Westminster parliamentary democracy in 1991 (1991–2026), the office of Prime Minister of Bangladesh has been occupied for nearly 32 years of elected partisan government (1991–2006, 2009–2024, and 2026—interrupted only by non-partisan Caretaker administrations in 2006–2008 and the 2024–2026 post-uprising Interim Government) by a member of just two political families: the Tungipara Sheikh dynasty (`FAM-001`, led by Sheikh Hasina, daughter of founding President and Prime Minister Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, across five premierships in 1996–2001 and 2009–2024) and the Majumder–Zia dynasty (`FAM-002`, led by Begum Khaleda Zia, widow of assassinated President Ziaur Rahman, across three premierships in 1991–1996 and 2001–2006, and by her son Prime Minister Tarique Rahman following the February 2026 general election of the 13th Parliament) [4, 18, 29, 52]. Even the principal third party of the post-1990 era, the Jatiya Party (JP), has operated as a hereditary enterprise controlled by former military President Hussain Muhammad Ershad, his wife Begum Rowshan Ershad, his brother Ghulam Muhammed Quader (GM Quader), his son Rahgir Almahe Saad Ershad, and their extended kin (`FAM-003`) [56, 60].

Despite the centrality of family networks to Bangladeshi governance, existing empirical scholarship has been constrained by severe scope limitations and fragmentary data. In a foundational London School of Economics doctoral dissertation, Rahman [51] pioneered the quantitative analysis of Bangladeshi dynasties across a two-parliament cross-section—the 8th (2001) and 9th (2008) Jatiya Sangsads ($N = 536$ MPs)—testing whether dynastic parliamentarians behave as long-horizon "stationary bandits" [45] in local infrastructure utilization and leveraging $N = 97$ historical assassination attempts (1971–2010) to identify the causal "martyrdom effect" of violent death on family succession. More recently, Shatil [56] compiled candidate nomination data for the Awami League (AL) and Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) across four general elections (2001, 2008, 2024, and 2026) in Bangladesh's 300 territorial constituencies, showing that 159 constituencies featured dynastic nominees and arguing that dynastic nominations spike during uncompetitive or boycotted elections. In parallel, qualitative political scientists [4, 29, 55, 60–62] have examined how "inheritance of blood" supersedes "inheritance of ideology" at the pinnacle of major secular parties, minor leftist factions, and Islamist movements, while investigative journalists [18, 43] have mapped the entry of 21 second-generation lawmakers in the 2026 13th Parliament and dense inter-party marriage alliances (*beyai*, *samdhi*, and *vaira-bhai* ties).

However, four fundamental questions in comparative politics remain unanswered because no prior study has assembled a complete, forensically audited longitudinal census of both the legislature and the executive Cabinet across Bangladesh's entire post-independence history (1973–2026):

1. **The Executive Gatekeeping Puzzle (RQ1 — Why Does the Dynastic Premium Peak Inside the Cabinet and Among Freshmen?):** Almost all comparative econometric studies of political dynasties focus on *legislative entry* and *incumbency advantage*—why family candidates win party nominations and parliamentary seats [13, 17, 50, 56]. Very little work examines what happens *after* dynastic politicians enter the legislature, particularly in non-Western parliamentary regimes where executive ministries control vast patronage rents [57, 63]. In our complete 53-year census ($N = 4,527$ seat records), dynastic MPs hold 22.40% of all parliamentary seats ($1,014/4,527$), yet they capture 38.67% **of all Cabinet appointments** ($565/1,461$), 45.42% **of high-rent sovereign ministries** ($332/731$), and 48.00% **of senior executive posts** (Prime Minister, Full Cabinet Minister, or Ministerial Adviser: $432/900$). Expressed as individual appointment probabilities, 55.72% **of dynastic MP seat-terms result in a Cabinet portfolio** compared to just 25.51% **of non-dynastic seat-terms**—a $2.18\times$ **unconditional Cabinet Premium** ($\chi^2 = 336.1, p < 0.0001$). Even more remarkably, this premium is *not* an artifact of dynastic MPs serving more terms: among **first-term freshman MPs**, dynasts enter the Cabinet at $2.66\times$ **the rate of non-dynasts** (41.72% vs. 15.70%) and attain **Full Cabinet Ministries at** $3.88\times$ **the rate of non-dynasts** (29.58% vs. 7.63%). Why do party chiefs systematically bypass seasoned grass-roots legislators to fast-track dynastic novices directly into high-rent ministerial portfolios?

2. **The Regime-Cycle, Military Co-Optation, and Pre-Loss vs. Post-Defeat Puzzle (RQ2):** How do macro-institutional regime transitions—military coups (1975, 1982), military-backed presidential parliaments (2nd, 3rd, and 4th Parliaments), neutral Caretaker Government (CTG) democratic alternation (5th, 7th, 8th, and 9th Parliaments), opposition electoral boycotts (1988 4th, Feb 1996 6th, 2014 10th, and 2024 12th Parliaments), and mass revolutionary overthrow (the August 2024 uprising and February 2026 13th Parliament)—reshape party reliance on political dynasties? Extending Shatil [56] across all 13 parliaments uncovers three striking regularities: (a) under military governments (Ziaur Rahman and H. M. Ershad), backbenchers were overwhelmingly non-dynastic (92.57% non-dynastic), yet military rulers packed a third of their Cabinets (33.95%) with co-opted dynastic elites; (b) democratization in 1991 triggered a permanent structural leap in parliamentary dynastic share from 11.5% (1988) to 24.7% (1991) and 30.7% (1996); and (c) ruling parties experience a mild *pre-loss dynastic dilution* during late-stage overreach (such as AL's 2024 "dummy candidate" strategy), followed by an immediate *post-defeat opposition bunker surge* (51.6% dynastic for AL in 2001; 30.8% for BNP in June 1996) when defeated at the polls.
3. **The Cross-Party Kinship Insurance and Generational Reproduction Puzzle (RQ2b):** In a zero-sum, winner-take-all polity where losing executive power routinely exposes politicians to politicized prosecution, asset confiscation, or party bans [24, 32, 53], how have 170 elite families managed to survive for over half a century, with second- and third-generation heirs surpassing first-generation founders from the 10th Parliament (2014) onward to reach 81.5% **of all dynastic MPs in 2026**? We show that 35.29% **of all political dynasties (**60/170**)** actively diversify party affiliations across rival ideological blocs through blood and affinal marriage alliances, extending their institutional survival from 4.15 to 5.38 parliaments ($p = 0.0007$).
4. **The Gendered Pathways and "Death-Gate" Incubator Puzzle (RQ3):** Why do 71.6% (48/67) of all unique women ever elected to competitive general seats in Bangladesh (78.8% [119/151] of female general-seat victories) come from political dynasties, and why do female dynastic MPs experience sharply divergent executive careers depending on whether they enter parliament as **widows/wives** (53.1% of female dynasts, often via mid-term "death-gate" by-elections, but with only a 9.3% **Cabinet appointment rate**) versus **patrilineal daughters** (38.3% of female dynasts, who achieve a 35.5% **Cabinet appointment rate**—a 3.81× executive advantage)? And how have Bangladesh's Reserved Women's Seats evolved from an affirmative-action quota into a two-stage dynastic incubator?

Core Contribution to the Comparative Politics Literature: By uniting a forensically verified 53-year population census ($N = 4,527$) with five-tier executive portfolios, multi-way clustered econometric models, and 170 family kinship graphs, this article demonstrates that political dynasties in South Asia operate not merely as local electoral machines, but as an **executive gatekeeping cartel** and an **inter-party regime insurance network** that reproduces hereditary rule across autocratic, democratic, and post-revolutionary transitions.

2 Comparative Literature Review and Formal Theoretical Framework

2.1 Situating Bangladesh in the Global Political Economy of Dynasties

Comparative scholarship on political dynasties divides into two broad explanatory camps: *voter-side (demand) theories* and *party-elite (supply and gatekeeping) theories*. Demand-side explanations emphasize voter information asymmetries, clientelist brokerage, and brand-name recognition in weak-state environments. Seminal work on the United States Congress by Dal Bó et al. [17] and Feinstein [19] established that holding legislative office endogenously generates "dynastic capital"—name recognition, fundraising networks, and donor contacts—such that merely winning a narrow re-election doubles the probability that a legislator's relative later enters Congress. In developing democracies with clientelist voter–politician linkages, such as the Philippines [39, 50, 59], India [11, 13, 22], and Pakistan [3, 14, 38],

voters evaluate candidates not on programmatic legislative platforms, but on their perceived capacity (*khomota* or bargaining leverage) to extract localized public goods, targeted transfers, and police protection from central ministries [10, 27, 51]. In such environments, a dynastic surname signals credible access to state patronage and commands an inherited hierarchy of local intermediaries (*mastans*, union parishad chairmen, and bazaar committees) [28, 31, 33, 34, 36, 46, 55, 58].

Supply-side and organizational theories, building on Michels [40], Putnam [49], and Panebianco [48], argue that dynastic proliferation is fundamentally driven by **weak internal party institutionalization and leadership insecurity** [4, 15, 57]. Analyzing Indian political parties, Chhibber [15] and Chandra [13] demonstrate that parties lacking autonomous local membership organizations and transparent internal elections rely heavily on dynastic succession to prevent organizational collapse and factional defection. In Bangladesh, Amundsen [4], Jahan [29], and Uddin [60, 61, 62] show that internal party democracy is virtually absent inside both the Awami League and the BNP: party constitutions vest absolute authority over candidate nominations and central committee appointments in the party chief. Yet existing supply-side studies stop at the threshold of parliamentary nomination. They do not explain why dynastic advantage escalates dramatically *inside* Parliament when prime ministers and military presidents allocate executive Cabinet portfolios [57], nor how dynastic families navigate violent regime changes across five decades. Below, we formalize five testable theoretical mechanisms that bridge legislative recruitment, executive gatekeeping, and regime survival.

2.2 Mechanism 1: The Principal–Agent Coup-Proofing Model of Executive Gatekeeping (RQ1 / H1 & H3)

In a parliamentary or hybrid presidential–parliamentary system characterized by clientelist rent extraction and recurrent threats of intra-party mutiny or military intervention, a head of government (the Principal, P) faces a severe **principal–agent and coup-proofing problem** when appointing Cabinet ministers (Agents, $i \in \{1, \dots, N\}$) [4, 7, 8]. Full Cabinet ministries—particularly high-rent sovereign and infrastructural portfolios such as Finance, Home Affairs, Local Government and Rural Development (LGRD), Road Transport and Bridges, Power and Energy, and Commerce—control billions of dollars in public procurement, regulatory licenses, and law-enforcement authority [24, 32, 34].

If the party leader appoints an ambitious, self-made grass-roots politician ($D_i = 0$) who has built an independent constituency following over multiple terms ($T_{i,t}$), the leader incurs a significant **agency and defection risk**: the non-dynastic minister may use state patronage to build an autonomous factional power base, challenge the party leadership, or defect to a military usurper or rival coalition during a regime crisis. Bangladesh's political history is punctuated by precisely such elite betrayals by senior non-dynastic ministers: Khondaker Mostaq Ahmad and several senior ministers defects after the August 15, 1975 assassination of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman; senior Awami League and Muslim League politicians defected to Ziaur Rahman's BNP in 1978–1979 (such as Shah Azizur Rahman) and to H. M. Ershad's Jatiya Party in 1983–1986 (such as Mizanur Rahman Chowdhury and Korban Ali); and senior non-dynastic party barons backed the military-installed "minus-two" reformist purge during the 2007–2008 state of emergency [1, 2, 25, 26, 29, 30, 35, 41, 44, 52].

Appointing a dynastic parliamentarian ($D_i = 1$) to the Cabinet resolves this agency dilemma through three reinforcing channels:

1. **Co-Specific Reputational Lock-In and Loyalty Insurance:** Second- and third-generation scions of the party's founding families—such as Syed Ashraful Islam (`FAM-004`, son of 1971 Acting President Syed Nazrul Islam), Tanjim Ahmad Sohel Taj and Begum Simeen Hussain Rimi (`FAM-005`, children of 1971 Prime Minister Tajuddin Ahmad), Mohammed Nasim and Tanvir Shakil Joy (`FAM-006`, son and grandson of 1975 Prime Minister Captain M. Mansur Ali), Sheikh Fazlul Karim Selim and Abul Hasanat Abdullah (`FAM-001`, nephews of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman), or Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir (`FAM-013`) and Dr. Abdul Moyeen Khan (`FAM-160`) in the BNP—possess political capital that is *co-specific* to the party's founding brand. Their family's historical legacy and social standing would be destroyed by defecting to an ideological arch-rival, providing the party leader with credible loyalty insurance [4, 60].

2. **Safe-Seat Electoral Insulation:** Because dynastic MPs inherit entrenched local machines, commercial wealth, and multi-term re-election advantages (2.53 vs. 1.52 terms), they face lower electoral vulnerability in their home constituencies [51, 56], enabling the Prime Minister to entrust them with national executive portfolios or fast-track them into the Cabinet in their very first parliamentary term ($T_{i,t} = 1$).
3. **Multi-Constituency Clan Appeasement:** Appointing the heir of a major regional political family to a full ministry cements the loyalty of an entire multi-seat regional kinship bloc (such as the Raozan Chowdhury network in Chittagong [`FAM-145`], the Saifur Rahman family in Sylhet/Moulvibazar [`FAM-129`], or the Serajul Huq–Anisul Huq family in Brahmanbaria [`FAM-134`]).

Formally, let the party leader's net expected utility $U^*_{i,p,t}$ from appointing MP i of party p in parliament t to executive tier $Y_{i,p,t} \in \{0, 1\}$ (where Y denotes any Cabinet post, Full Cabinet Minister/PM, or a High-Rent Sovereign Portfolio) be:

$$U^*_{i,c,p,t} = \alpha + \beta_1 \,\text{Dynastic}_i + \beta_2 \,(\text{Tenure}_{i,t} - 1) + \beta_3 \,[\text{Dynastic}_i \times (\text{Tenure}_{i,t} - 1)] + \gamma \,\text{Reserved}_{i,c,t} + \mu_p + \tau_t + \varepsilon_{i,c,p,t} \tag{1}$$

where $U^*_{i,c,p,t} = \mathbb{E}[\Pi_{i,c,p,t}] + \varepsilon_{i,c,p,t}$ reflects the Prime Minister's net governance payoff $\Pi_{i,c,p,t} = \theta_i + \lambda(\text{Tenure}_{i,t} - 1) - \kappa \Pr(\text{Defection}_{i,t} = 1 \mid \text{Dynastic}_i, R_t)$ of appointing MP i (representing constituency c in party p and parliament t), $\text{Dynastic}_i \in \{0, 1\}$ equals 1 if MP i belongs to one of the 170 political dynasties (lowering defection hazard by $\Delta_{\text{def}} > 0$), $\text{Tenure}_{i,t} - 1 \geq 0$ measures cumulative prior parliaments served up to parliament t (centered at first-term entry $\text{Tenure}_{i,t} = 1$ so that $\beta_1 = \kappa\Delta_{\text{def}}$ directly identifies the freshman fast-track premium), $\text{Reserved}_{i,c,t} \in \{0, 1\}$ indicates a Reserved Women's Seat, μ_p and τ_t are party and parliament fixed effects ($t \in \{1, \ldots, 13\}$), and $\varepsilon_{i,c,p,t}$ is clustered at the family/individual level ($G = 2,482$ exact clusters, or $G = 2,190$ root-name clusters) and constituency level ($G = 545$ clusters).

Hypothesis 1 (Dynastic Career Longevity & Veteran Concentration — H1)**.** *Controlling for entry cohort, political party, and seat type across all unique legislators, dynastic MPs serve significantly more parliamentary terms and exhibit a significantly higher probability of becoming four-or-more-term parliamentary veterans than non-dynastic MPs.*

Hypothesis 2 (The Net Executive Gatekeeping Premium, Sovereign Capture & Freshman Fast-Track — H2 / RQ1)**.** *(a) Dynastic status exerts a large, positive, and statistically significant direct effect on any Cabinet appointment ($\beta_1 > 0$), Full Ministerial appointment, and High-Rent Sovereign Portfolio appointment after conditioning on cumulative parliamentary seniority ($\text{Tenure}_{i,t}$), seat type, party fixed effects (μ_p), and parliament fixed effects (τ_t); and (b) the relative risk ratio (and odds ratio) of dynastic over non-dynastic executive appointment is steepest among first-term freshmen ($\text{Tenure}_{i,t} = 1$), demonstrating that family pedigree substitutes for multi-term legislative apprenticeship.*

2.3 Mechanism 2: Military Co-Optation, The Democratic Dynastic Paradox, and Pre-Loss Dilution vs. Post-Defeat Bunkers (RQ2 / H2 & H5)

How do authoritarian reversals, competitive Caretaker transitions, and electoral boycotts alter the equilibrium prevalence of dynasties? We theorize three regime-cycle mechanisms:

- **Military Party-Building on the Backbenches vs. Elite Co-Optation in the Cabinet:** When military rulers seize power (Major General Ziaur Rahman in 1975–1981 and Lieutenant General H. M. Ershad in 1982–1990) and construct civilianized ruling parties (BNP in 1978–1979; Jatiya Party in 1986), they use state intelligence agencies and local patronage to recruit first-generation business newcomers, retired civil–military bureaucrats, and rural councilors onto the parliamentary backbenches [10, 34]. Consequently, backbench dynastic share under military parliaments is exceptionally low (6.61% in 1979; 3.91% in 1988). However, to run high-profile ministries and project national political authority, military rulers aggressively poach scions of established pre-1971 political families directly into the Cabinet (33.0%–34.7% dynastic), producing a massive Cabinet-to-Backbench dynastic ratio (4.57× pooled, and 8.87× in 1988).

- **The Democratic Dynastic Paradox & The Pre-Loss Dilution / Post-Defeat Bunker Cycle:** Once competitive parliamentary elections are restored under neutral Caretaker Governments (1991–2008), the cost of financing campaigns and mobilizing voters without state coercion skyrockets [51, 56]. Parties shift nominations heavily toward candidates with self-financed family machines, causing dynastic seat share to more than double from 11.5% (1988) to 24.7% (1991) and 30.7% (1996). Within this competitive cycle, a two-phase fluctuation governs power transitions: during late-stage incumbency overreach or boycotted elections (such as BNP in Feb 1996 or Awami League's "dummy candidate" election in Jan 2024), ruling parties dilute their dynastic share slightly by inducting non-dynastic loyalists or independent businessmen; conversely, when a party suffers a national electoral rout in a competitive election (BNP in 1996 and 2008; AL in 2001), non-dynastic MPs in marginal constituencies are wiped out first, leaving the defeated party's surviving caucus heavily concentrated inside impenetrable family "bunkers" (51.6% dynastic for AL in 2001).
- **Cross-Party Kinship Diversification as Informal Regime Insurance (H5):** In an adversarial political settlement where regime change brings existential risks of imprisonment, exile, or party proscription [32, 53], elite families hedge political risk by placing brothers, cousins, or affinal in-laws (*beyai*, *samdhi*, *vaira-bhai*) across rival political parties [43]. Formally, if family f maintains active parliamentarians across distinct party camps $\mathcal{P}_f$ with $|\mathcal{P}_f| \geq 2$, its probability of retaining at least one parliamentary or executive protector under any ruling regime $R_t \in \{\text{AL}, \text{BNP}, \text{JP}, \text{Military}\}$ strictly exceeds that of a single-party dynasty:

$$S_{f,t} = \Pr\left(\bigcup_{m \in \mathcal{M}_f} \{I_{m,t} = 1\}\right) = 1 - (1 - p_{1,t})(1 - p_{2,t}) - \text{Cov}(I_{1,t}, I_{2,t}) \tag{2}$$

  where $I_{m,t} \in \{0, 1\}$ is the seat-victory indicator of family member $m \in \{1, 2\}$ with marginal win probability $p_{m,t} = \mathbb{E}[I_{m,t}]$. In a single-party dynasty ($p(1) = p(2) = A$), an electoral boycott, party ban, or anti-incumbent wave hits both kinsmen simultaneously, inducing positive shock covariance ($\text{Cov}_{\text{Single}}(I_{1,t}, I_{2,t}) > 0$) and depressing family survival $S_{f,t}^{\text{Single}}$. Conversely, when a dynasty places kinsmen across rival parties ($p(1) = A, p(2) = B$), a regime transition that depresses Party A's win probability simultaneously elevates Party B's win probability, inducing negative covariance ($\text{Cov}_{\text{Cross}}(I_{1,t}, I_{2,t}) < 0$) and strictly raising trans-regime survival: $\Delta S_{f,t} \equiv S_{f,t}^{\text{Cross}} - S_{f,t}^{\text{Single}} = \text{Cov}_{\text{Single}} - \text{Cov}_{\text{Cross}} > 0$.

Hypothesis 3 (The "Death-Gate" By-Election Succession Mechanism — H3)**.** *Following the mid-term death or assassination of an incumbent MP, political parties overwhelmingly nominate an immediate family member (widow, son, daughter, or sibling) to capture the sympathy dividend and prevent local factional splintering, resulting in recurrent intra-family seat inheritance in prominent death-triggered mid-term by-elections (Table 11).*

Hypothesis 4 (Military Co-Optation, Pre-Loss/Post-Defeat Cycles, and Multi-Party Family Survival — H4 / RQ2)**.** *(a) Military regimes exhibit low backbench dynastic share ($< 12\%$) but high Cabinet dynastic share ($> 33\%$); (b) competitive electoral defeats sharply increase the dynastic concentration of a party's surviving caucus; and (c) dynastic families that diversify across two or more political party camps survive across significantly more parliaments by expanding family network size and securing executive Cabinet protection.*

2.4 Mechanism 3: The Gendered Gateway, Widow Custodianship vs. Patrilineal Escalation, and the Reserved-Seat Incubator (RQ3 / H4)

In deeply patriarchal electoral arenas, female candidates without male elite sponsorship face prohibitive social, financial, and security barriers in direct constituency contests [6, 9, 16, 42, 47]. Consequently, kinship serves as the primary gateway for female entry into the Jatiya Sangsad ($> 72\%$ of directly elected female general-seat MPs). However, we theorize a sharp institutional divergence between two female kinship pathways:

1. **Spousal / Widow Succession (The Custodial Ceiling):** When a male MP dies suddenly, is assassinated, or is disqualified, party leadership nominates his wife or widow to hold the family bastion

[51, 60]. Outside the two national party matriarchs (Begum Khaleda Zia and Begum Rowshan Ershad), party elites view parliamentary widows as *symbolic custodians* rather than policy executives, imposing a glass ceiling on their promotion into the Cabinet.

2. **Patrilineal Father–Daughter Inheritance & The Reserved-Seat Incubator:** When a senior male politician grooms an educated daughter as his primary political heir—often inducting her first through Bangladesh's indirect quota of **Reserved Women's Seats** (15 seats in 1973; 30 in 1979–2001; 45 in 2004; 50 since 2011) before transitioning her into a directly contested General Seat—she inherits her father's vertical ministerial network and achieves high rates of executive Cabinet promotion.

Hypothesis 5 (The Gendered Gateway & Patrilineal Executive Escalator — H5 / RQ3)**.** *While spousal/widow succession is the modal entry channel for female dynastic MPs ($> 50\%$), patrilineal heirs (daughters/granddaughters) achieve more than triple the Cabinet appointment rate of widows, and dynastic women who transition through Reserved Women's Seats into General Seats achieve the highest executive promotion rate of any female cohort.*

3 Census Data Architecture, Delimitation Concordance, and Six-Gate Forensic Audit

To test Hypotheses 1–5 across the entire universe of Bangladeshi legislators without sample-selection bias or homonym measurement error, we constructed and audited a five-layer relational database covering every parliamentary session, mid-term by-election, and executive Cabinet from 7 March 1973 to February 2026:

1. **Master Seat-Level Dataset (`bangladesh_mps_..._1973_2026.csv`):** Contains $N = 4,527$ individual seat-tenure records across 20 standardized variables, partitioned into four verified chronological batches: Batch 1 (1st–3rd Parliaments, 1973–1988: 983 rows), Batch 2 (4th–6th Parliaments, 1988–1996: 987 rows), Batch 3 (7th–9th Parliaments, 1996–2014: 1,098 rows), and Batch 4 (10th–13th Parliaments, 2014–2026: 1,459 rows; $983 + 987 + 1,098 + 1,459 = 4,527$).
2. **Master Dynastic Profiles Registry (`bangladesh_mp_dynastic_relations_1973_2026.csv`):** Catalogs all 401 unique dynastic MPs across 15 biographical, career-cabinet, generational, and bidirectional relational variables.
3. **Dynastic Families Summary Index (`dynastic_families_summary_index_170_families.csv`):** Aggregates total MPs (401), cumulative seat wins (1,014), generational depth, highest Cabinet rank, founding patriarchs, and multi-party affiliations across all 170 political dynasties (`FAM-001` to `FAM-170`).

Resolving the 1973–1986 Territorial Delimitation Overhaul: A major methodological barrier to longitudinal constituency research in Bangladesh is the administrative boundary restructuring between the 2nd (1979) and 3rd (1986) Parliaments. In the 1st (1973) and 2nd (1979) Parliaments, Bangladesh was divided into **19 Greater Districts** inherited from the late colonial and East Pakistan eras (Greater Dinajpur, Rangpur, Bogra, Rajshahi, Pabna, Kushtia, Jessore, Khulna, Bakerganj/Barisal, Patuakhali, Tangail, Mymensingh, Dacca, Faridpur, Sylhet, Comilla, Noakhali, Chittagong, and Chittagong Hill Tracts), with seat numbers running sequentially up to `Mymensingh-32` and `Dacca-32`. Following the 1984 Upazila administrative decentralization, the Election Commission re-delimited the 300 general constituencies into **64 modern districts** beginning with the 7 May 1986 general election (3rd Parliament). For example, Sheikh Fazlul Karim Selim's seat in Gopalganj was designated `Faridpur-10` in the 2nd Parliament (1979) before becoming `Gopalganj-2` from the 3rd to 12th Parliaments; Abul Hasanat Abdullah's seat was `Bakerganj-1` before becoming `Barisal-1`; and President Mohammad Abdul Hamid's seat in Mithamain–Itna–Austagram was `Mymensingh-30` in 1973 before becoming `Kishoreganj-5` and `Kishoreganj-4`. Our database records the exact official Election Commission Gazette constituency title for each election while linking every MP and family across pre- and post-1986 delimitation boundaries.

Standardized Five-Tier Article 56 Executive Taxonomy & Six Forensic Integrity Gates: In accordance with Article 56 of the Constitution of Bangladesh, executive positions are coded into five mutually exclusive tiers: Tier 1 (`Prime Minister`, comprising the 11 unique elected MPs who held the constitutional office of Prime Minister—8 dynastic [Tajuddin Ahmad, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, Capt. M. Mansur Ali, Ataur Rahman Khan, Barrister Moudud Ahmed, Begum Khaleda Zia, Sheikh Hasina, and Tarique Rahman] and 3 non-dynastic [Shah Azizur Rahman, Mizanur Rahman Chowdhury, and Kazi Zafar Ahmed]—plus 2 dynastic leaders holding Presidential or Prime-Minister-equivalent rank [former President H. M. Ershad and Senior Minister with PM rank Mashiur Rahman Jadu Mia]; because party leaders won multiple seats simultaneously across elections—such as Khaleda Zia's 22 seat records, Hasina's 16, and Ershad's 15—these 13 unique individuals account for 76 cumulative parliamentary seat records [67 dynastic and 9 non-dynastic]), Tier 2 (`Cabinet Minister`, 291 unique MPs [100 dynastic, 191 non-dynastic] across 809 seat records, plus 9 Cabinet-Rank Advisers across 15 seat records), Tier 3 (`State Minister`, 221 unique MPs [49 dynastic, 172 non-dynastic] across 502 seat records), Tier 4 (`Deputy Minister`, 25 unique MPs [5 dynastic, 20 non-dynastic] across 59 seat records), and Tier 5 (`None`, 2,154 unique backbench MPs across 3,066 seat records). Additionally, to test Hypothesis 3 on rent extraction and coup-proofing, we code a binary indicator for **High-Rent Sovereign and Infrastructural Portfolios** ($n = 731$ seat-terms), encompassing the Prime Ministership and the Ministries of Finance, Home Affairs, Foreign Affairs, Defence, LGRD, Communications/Road Transport/Shipping/Railways, Power/Energy, Commerce, Industries, Law, Planning, Education, and Water Resources.

Every row of the database was validated against **six automated forensic integrity gates**: (1) *Zero Orphaned or Double-Matched Profiles* (401 unique dynastic profiles mapping to 1,014 seat wins with zero duplicate matches); (2) *Exact Row-Count Partition Sum* (4,527 rows); (3) *Strict Post-Mortem & Homonym Disambiguation Gate*, separating politicians with identical names across districts and eras (e.g., ensuring Founding President Sheikh Mujibur Rahman of `1st Dhaka-12` [assassinated 15 August 1975] is never conflated with BNP MP Sheikh Mujibur Rahman of `6th Bagerhat-1` [Feb 1996], Engineer Sheikh Mujibur Rahman of `9th Satkhira-1`, or Sheikh Mujibur Rahman Iqbal of `13th Kishoreganj-5`; and disambiguating multiple distinct MPs named `Abdul Mannan`, `Mosharraf Hossain`, `Abul Kalam Azad`, and `Rafiqul Islam` by pairing normalized names with geographic district roots); (4) *Historical Party-Boycott Gate* (verifying zero BNP MPs in the 1st, 3rd, 4th, 10th, and 12th Parliaments, and zero Awami League MPs in the 4th, 6th, and 13th Parliaments); (5) *Bidirectional Kinship Reciprocity Gate* across all 170 families; and (6) *Zero-Latin Unicode Bengali Verification* across all `MP_Name_BN` entries.

4 Longitudinal Chronicle, Party Architectures, Military Co-Optation, and the Pre-Loss vs. Post-Defeat Cycle (1973–2026)

4.1 The Institutional Trajectory Across All 13 Parliaments (1973–2026)

Table 1 presents the complete longitudinal trajectory of dynastic representation across all 13 Parliaments of Bangladesh from 1973 to 2026, disaggregating General Seats ($n = 4,063$), Reserved Women's Seats ($n = 464$), Cabinet appointments ($n = 1,461$), and major political party caucuses.

Table 1: Longitudinal Trajectory of Dynastic Representation Across All 13 Parliaments of Bangladesh (1973–2026)

Parl. (Term)	Regime Era & Institutional Milestone	Total	Dyn. Seats (%)	Gen. Dyn. (%)	Res. Dyn. (%)	Cab. Dyn. (%)	AL Dyn. (%)	BNP Dyn. (%)	JP Dyn. (%)
1st (1973–75)	Founding Republic; 4th Amend. (BAKSAL)	317	54 (17.0%)	51/302 (16.9%)	3/15 (20.0%)	25/66 (37.9%)	53/311 (17.0%)	*Not Founded*	*Not Founded*
2nd (1979–82)	Military Presidential I (Zia; BNP Founding)	335	52 (15.5%)	50/305 (16.4%)	2/30 (6.7%)	37/108 (34.3%)	6/43 (14.0%)	40/252 (15.9%)	*Not Founded*
3rd (1986–87)	Military Presidential II (Ershad; BNP Boycott)	331	57 (17.2%)	54/301 (17.9%)	3/30 (10.0%)	29/88 (33.0%)	21/82 (25.6%)	*Boycotted*	30/207 (14.5%)
4th (1988–90)	Military Boycotted III (AL/BNP Boycott; 0 Res.)	305	35 (**11.5%**)	35/305 (11.5%)	0/0 (0.0%)	26/75 (34.7%)	*Boycotted*	*Boycotted*	35/266 (13.2%)
5th (1991–95)	Democratic Restoration (12th Amend. Parl.)	352	87 (24.7%)	82/322 (25.5%)	5/30 (16.7%)	56/136 (41.2%)	29/98 (29.6%)	40/182 (22.0%)	12/39 (30.8%)
6th (Feb 1996)	12-Day Assembly (13th Amend. Caretaker; Boycott)	330	59 (17.9%)	54/300 (18.0%)	5/30 (16.7%)	38/83 (45.8%)	*Boycotted*	59/319 (18.5%)	*Boycotted*
7th (1996–01)	Caretaker Alternation II (First Full 5-Yr Term)	358	110 (**30.7%**)	106/328 (**32.3%**)	4/30 (13.3%)	69/168 (41.1%)	58/194 (29.9%)	**37/120 (30.8%)**	14/38 (36.8%)
8th (2001–06)	Caretaker Alternation III (14th Amend. 45 Res.)	371	108 (29.1%)	104/326 (31.9%)	4/45 (8.9%)	66/141 (**46.8%**)	**33/64 (51.6%)**	63/252 (25.0%)	6/18 (33.3%)
9th (2009–14)	Caretaker IV → 15th Amend. (CTG Abolished)	369	98 (26.6%)	92/319 (28.8%)	6/50 (12.0%)	59/156 (37.8%)	70/287 (24.4%)	**11/39 (28.2%)**	13/32 (**40.6%**)
10th (2014–19)	Dominant-Party I (BNP Boycott; 153 Uncontested)	367	102 (27.8%)	96/317 (30.3%)	6/50 (12.0%)	52/140 (37.1%)	84/290 (29.0%)	*Boycotted*	10/45 (22.2%)
11th (2019–24)	Dominant-Party II (COVID By-Elections; BNP Resign)	390	**115 (29.5%)**	100/336 (29.8%)	**15/54 (27.8%)**	47/137 (34.3%)	97/334 (29.0%)	**3/8 (37.5%)**	9/30 (30.0%)
12th (Jan 2024)	Dominant-Party III ("Dummy" Ind.; July Uprising)	351	83 (23.6%)	76/301 (25.2%)	7/50 (14.0%)	33/95 (34.7%)	73/273 (26.7%)	*Boycotted*	3/13 (23.1%)
13th (2026–)	Post-Revolutionary Restoration (AL Barred; BNP Maj.)	351	54 (15.4%)	49/301 (16.3%)	5/50 (10.0%)	28/68 (**41.2%**)	*Barred/Absent*	50/249 (20.1%)	*0 Seats*
Total / All	**53-Year Complete Census (1st–13th Parliaments)**	**4,527**	**1,014 (22.4%)**	**949/4,063 (23.4%)**	**65/464 (14.0%)**	**565/1,461 (38.7%)**	**524/1,976 (26.5%)**	**303/1,421 (21.3%)**	**132/688 (19.2%)**

Figure 1: Visualizing the 53-Year Trajectory of Dynastic Power in Bangladesh: All Seats vs. Contemporaneous In-Term Cabinet & Partisan Bunker Spikes (1st–13th Parliaments, 1973–2026)

Parl. (Year)	Regime Era	All Seats %	Parliamentary Seat Bar (22.4% Base)	In-Term Cab. % (Career %)	Contemporaneous Cabinet Bar (40.8% Base)	AL / BNP Caucus %
1st (1973)	Founding	17.0%		32.6% (37.9%)		AL: 17.0% / BNP: —
2nd (1979)	Military I (Zia)	15.5%		36.1% (34.3%)		AL: 14.0% / BNP: 15.9%
3rd (1986)	Military II (Ershad)	17.2%		27.1% (33.0%)		AL: 25.6% / BNP: Boyc.
4th (1988)	Military III (Boyc.)	11.5%		33.3% (34.7%)		JP: 13.2% (Both Boyc.)
5th (1991)	Caretaker I (BNP)	24.7%		47.8% (41.2%)		AL: 29.6% / BNP: 22.0%
6th (Feb 96)	12-Day Assembly	17.9%		47.4% (45.8%)		BNP: 19.2% (Named)
7th (Jun 96)	Caretaker II (AL)	**30.7%**		48.6% (41.1%)		AL: 29.9% / **BNP: 30.8%**
8th (2001)	Caretaker III (BNP)	29.1%		**58.6%** (46.8%)		**AL: 51.6%** / BNP: 25.0%
9th (2009)	Caretaker IV (AL)	26.6%		35.3% (37.8%)		AL: 24.4% / BNP: 28.2%
10th (2014)	Dominant-Party I	27.8%		35.2% (37.1%)		AL: 29.0% / JP: 22.2%
11th (2019)	Dominant-Party II	29.5%		36.8% (34.3%)		AL: 29.0% / **BNP: 37.5%**
12th (2024)	Dominant-Party III	23.6%		36.8% (34.7%)		AL: 26.7% / JP: 23.1%
13th (2026)	Post-Revolution	15.4%		**46.3%** (41.2%)		BNP: 20.2% (Named)

Notes: Contemporaneous In-Term Cabinet % ($n = 934$) measures service during that specific parliament; Career % ($n = 1,461$) is shown in parentheses.

Tracing the institutional evolution across all 13 parliaments reveals six distinct historical epochs:

1. **The Founding Republican Cohort (1st Parliament, 1973–1975):** Elected on 7 March 1973 (300 general seats + 15 reserved women's seats + 2 by-elections = 317 records), the 1st Parliament was swept by the Awami League (293 general seats). Although dominated by first-generation liberation movement leaders, 17.0% (54/317) of its members belonged to political families—and 37.9% **(**25/66**) of the Mujib/Mansur Ali Cabinets** were dynastic, anchored by Prime Minister Sheikh Mujibur Rahman (`FAM-001`, `Dhaka-12`), his brother-in-law Minister Abdur Rab Serniabat (`Bakerganj-13`), nephew Ilias Ahmed Chowdhury (`Faridpur-13`), future Presidents Mohammad Abdul Hamid (`FAM-008`) and Mohammed Zillur Rahman (`FAM-009`), the four national leaders (`FAM-004` to `FAM-007`), and A. K. M. Samsuzzoha of the Narayanganj Osman family (`FAM-113`). Following the 4th Amendment (BAKSAL) in January 1975, the republic was shattered by the 15 August 1975 military coup and assassination of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and his family, followed by the 3 November 1975 Jail Killings of Syed Nazrul Islam, Tajuddin Ahmad, Captain M. Mansur Ali, and A. H. M. Qamaruzzaman [29, 41].

2. **The Military-Backed Presidential Era (2nd, 3rd, and 4th Parliaments, 1979–1990):** Under President Ziaur Rahman's 2nd Parliament (elected 18 February 1979; 335 records including 30 reserved seats) and President H. M. Ershad's 3rd (7 May 1986; 331 records; boycotted by BNP) and 4th Parliaments (3 March 1988; 305 records; boycotted by both AL and BNP, with zero reserved seats as the 15-year constitutional reservation period [extended in 1979] had lapsed in December 1987), overall legislative dynastic share remained low (15.5% in 1979, 17.2% in 1986, and an all-time low of 11.5% **[**35/305**]** in 1988).

3. **The Democratic Restoration & Great Dynastic Leap (5th and 6th Parliaments, 1991–March 1996):** Following the December 1990 mass uprising that toppled Ershad, the 27 February 1991 election (5th Parliament, 352 records including 22 by-elections—11 filling seats vacated by multi-seat winners Begum Khaleda Zia, Sheikh Hasina, and H. M. Ershad or presidential election, and 11 filling mid-term deaths and vacancies) restored Westminster parliamentary democracy via the 12th Constitutional Amendment. Confirming our **Democratic Dynastic Paradox**, competitive elections caused dynastic representation to more than double from 11.5% (1988) to 24.7% **(**87/352**) in 1991** (41.2% in Khaleda Zia's Cabinet). When the opposition boycotted the 15 February 1996 election (6th Parliament, 330 records, convened for 12 sitting days solely to pass the 13th Amendment establishing the Non-Party Caretaker Government), BNP's uncontested intake temporarily diluted dynastic share to 17.9% (59/330).

4. **Peak Competitive Duopoly Under the Caretaker System (7th, 8th, and 9th Parliaments, June 1996–2014):** Across the three fiercely contested Caretaker elections of June 1996 (7th Parliament, won by Sheikh Hasina's Awami League), October 2001 (8th Parliament, won by Khaleda Zia's BNP–Four Party Alliance, which re-created and expanded reserved seats to 45 via the 14th Amendment in May 2004 after the prior provision had lapsed), and December 2008 (9th Parliament, won by AL's Grand Alliance after the 2007–2008 military-backed emergency, which expanded reserved seats to 50 and abolished the Caretaker system via the 15th Amendment in 2011), dynastic representation

reached its proportional zenith: 30.7% **(**110/358**) in the 7th Parliament** (32.3% in general seats), 29.1% **(**108/371**) in the 8th Parliament** (46.8% of the Cabinet), and 26.6% **(**98/369**) in the 9th Parliament** [4, 51].

5. **The Dominant-Party Hegemonic Era (10th, 11th, and 12th Parliaments, 2014–August 2024):** Following the abolition of the Caretaker system, the BNP boycotted the 5 January 2014 election (10th Parliament, 367 records, where 153 of 300 general seats were won uncontested and Ershad's Jatiya Party served simultaneously as Official Opposition and Cabinet partner), contested but rejected the 30 December 2018 "midnight election" (11th Parliament, 390 records including 40 mid-term by-elections triggered by the COVID-19 mortality wave and the December 2022 resignation of all 7 BNP MPs), and boycotted the 7 January 2024 election (12th Parliament, 351 records). Dynastic seat volume hit its **all-time numerical record of** 115 **seats (**29.5%**) in the 11th Parliament**, including an unprecedented 26.0% **(**13/50**) dynastic capture of Reserved Women's Seats** [56].

6. **The July–August 2024 Revolution and the 13th Parliament Restoration (February 2026–Present):** On 5–6 August 2024, just seven months into the 12th Parliament, a student- and citizen-led mass uprising forced Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina to flee to India and dissolved parliament [53]. In the subsequent February 2026 general election for the 13th Parliament (351 records, with the Awami League barred from participation), the BNP won a sweeping parliamentary majority under Prime Minister Tarique Rahman (`FAM-002`). While the influx of first-generation anti-authoritarian activists and 77 MPs from the Jamaat-e-Islami–led Islamist opposition bloc (68 general-seat Jamaat MPs plus allied Islamist and reserved-seat MPs) lowered total legislative dynastic share to 15.4% **(**54/351**)** (20.1% within the BNP caucus), **dynastic MPs still captured** 41.2% **(**28/68**) of the 2026 Cabinet**, and 81.5% **(**44/54**) of all dynastic MPs in the 13th Parliament are second- or third-generation inheritors** [18].

4.2 Party Dynastic Architectures, Military Co-Optation, and the Pre-Loss vs. Post-Defeat Cycle (Questions 1, 2 & 3)

Tables 2 and 3 provide direct quantitative answers to three core comparative questions: (1) How do Bangladesh's political parties differ in dynastic reliance? (2) How did military regimes practice dynastic politics? (3) Do dynasties increase or decrease before and after a party loses power?

Table 2: Dynastic Representation by Political Party Across Legislature and Cabinet (1973–2026, $N = 4,527$)

Political Party / Bloc	Total Seats	Dynastic Seats	Legislative Dyn. %	Total Cabinet	Dynastic Cabinet	Cabinet Dyn. %	Peak Dynastic Parliament (Bunker / Era)
Bangladesh Awami League (AL)	1,976	524	**26.52%**	738	265	35.91%	8th Parl. (2001 Opposition Rout: **51.6%**, 33/64)
Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP)	1,421	303	**21.32%**	462	192	**41.56%**	11th Parl. (37.5%, 3/8) & 7th Parl. (1996 Loss: **30.8%**, 37/120)
Jatiya Party (Ershad / JP)	688	132	**19.19%**	213	85	**39.91%**	9th Parl. (2009 Grand Alliance: **40.6%**, 13/32)
Other / Minor Parties (WP, BJP, BDB, JSD, LDP)	172	30	**17.44%**	35	18	**51.43%**	Family-led minor parties (`FAM-001`, `FAM-010`, `FAM-069`, `FAM-151`, `FAM-159`)
Independent MPs	136	19	**13.97%**	9	3	33.33%	10th Parl. (**31.3%**, 5/16) & 12th Parl. ("Dummy" Ind.: 9.7%, 6/62)
Bangladesh Jamaat-e-Islami	134	6	**4.48%**	4	2	50.00%	Cadre party; limited to Sayeedi family (`FAM-068`) & Quasem family
All Parties Combined (1973–2026)	**4,527**	**1,014**	**22.40%**	**1,461**	**565**	**38.67%**	**7th Parl. (30.7% rate) & 11th Parl. (115 seats)**

Table 3: Dynastic Practice Under Military-Backed Regimes: The Backbench vs. Cabinet Dichotomy (1979–1990)

Military-Era Parliament	Ruling Military Leader & Party	Total Seats	Backbench Dyn. (%)	Cabinet Dyn. (%)	Cab./Backbench Ratio	1st-Gen Founders	2nd/3rd-Gen Heirs
2nd Parliament (1979–1982)	Pres. Ziaur Rahman (BNP Founding)	335	**15 / 227 (6.61%)**	**37 / 108 (34.26%)**	**5.18**×	39 (75.0%)	13 (25.0%)
3rd Parliament (1986–1987)	Pres. H. M. Ershad (JP; BNP Boycott)	331	**28 / 243 (11.52%)**	**29 / 88 (32.95%)**	**2.86**×	35 (61.4%)	22 (38.6%)
4th Parliament (1988–1990)	Pres. H. M. Ershad (JP; Full Boycott)	305	**9 / 230 (3.91%)**	**26 / 75 (34.67%)**	**8.87**×	21 (60.0%)	14 (40.0%)
All Military Parliaments	**Pooled Military Era (2nd–4th Parls)**	**971**	**52 / 700 (7.43%)**	**92 / 271 (33.95%)**	**4.57**×	**95 (66.0%)**	**49 (34.0%)**

First, comparing party architectures (Table 2), the **Awami League** exhibits the highest legislative dynastic density at 26.52% **(**524/1,976 **seats)**, reflecting its seven-decade organizational lineage from 1949/1971, while the **BNP** (21.32% legislative dynastic share) exhibits an even higher **Cabinet dynastic share of** 41.56% **(**192/462**)** (39.91% in the **Jatiya Party** and 51.43% among **Minor Parties** [61]). At the opposite extreme, **Bangladesh Jamaat-e-Islami** exhibits a dynastic share of only 4.48% **(**6/134 **seats)** because its recruitment is governed by a lifelong ideological student-to-party cadre hierarchy (*Islami Chhatra Shibir* $\rightarrow$ *Rukon* membership) rather than family landholding networks [61].

Second, examining the military governments of Ziaur Rahman and H. M. Ershad (Table 3) uncovers a profound **Backbench vs. Cabinet Co-Optation Dichotomy**. Across all 700 backbench seat records in the 2nd (1979), 3rd (1986), and 4th (1988) Parliaments, **only** 7.43% **(**52/700**) were dynastic** (6.61% under Zia in 1979 and 3.91% under Ershad in 1988), as military intelligence agencies recruited non-dynastic local notables, business entrants, and retired officers to build new legislative majorities [10, 34]. Yet inside their **Executive Cabinets**, Zia (34.26% dynastic, 37/108) and Ershad (32.95% in 1986; 34.67% in 1988) relied heavily on established political families—a 4.57× **Cabinet-to-Backbench concentration ratio** (8.87× in 1988)! Because military juntas lacked organic political legitimacy, they systematically poached scions of pre-1971 Muslim League, Krishak Sramik, and Awami League families directly into ministerial office (such as Barrister Moudud Ahmed [FAM-138], Anwar Hossain Manju [FAM-069], Naziur Rahman Manzur and Sheikh Shahidul Islam [FAM-001], Salahuddin Quader Chowdhury [FAM-145], Chowdhury Kamal Ibne Yusuf [FAM-117], K. M. Obaidur Rahman [FAM-116], A. K. M. Maidul Islam Mukul [FAM-027], Shamsul Huda Chowdhury [FAM-015], Mirza Ghulam Hafiz [FAM-013], and M. Saifur Rahman [FAM-129]). Furthermore, 66.0% (95/144) of military-era dynastic seats belonged to first-generation patriarchs whose state-financed patronage networks later propelled their children into parliament after 1991.

Third, tracking ruling parties across regime transitions reveals a two-stage **Pre-Loss Dilution vs. Post-Defeat Bunker Cycle**:

- **Pre-Loss Dynastic Dilution During Late-Stage Overreach:** Right *before* a ruling party loses power—particularly when it manufactures an uncontested boycott election or rides a late-stage hegemonic wave—its dynastic share **declines modestly**: BNP dropped from 22.0% (1991) to 18.5% in the boycotted Feb 1996 6th Parliament before losing power in June 1996, and stood at 25.0% during its two-thirds landslide in 2001 before losing power in 2006/2008. Most dramatically, the Awami League held at 29.0% dynastic in the 10th (2014) and 11th (2019) Parliaments, but **dropped to** 26.7% **inside the official AL caucus—and** 23.6% **overall**—in the January 2024 12th Parliament because party leadership authorized 62 "dummy/independent" challengers (who were only 9.7% dynastic) to contest against official party nominees, splintering local party machines just seven months before the August 2024 revolution [53, 56].
- **Post-Defeat "Opposition Bunker Surge" When Defeated:** Conversely, in the election where a party *loses* power, its non-dynastic MPs in competitive swing seats are wiped out first, causing the surviving opposition caucus to become **overwhelmingly dynastic**: BNP jumped to 30.8% **(**37/120**)** in its June 1996 defeat and 28.2% **(**11/39**)** in its 2008 defeat (37.5% in 2018), while the Awami League surged from 29.9% (1996) to an all-time record 51.6% **(**33/64**)** in its October 2001 defeat.

5 Generational Cohort Crossover, Personal Seat Monopolization, and Family Survival Regressions (H1 & H5)

Table 4 documents both **generational cohort turnover** across the 1,014 dynastic seat wins (Panel A) and the **macro trend of personal incumbency persistence** across all 4,527 seat records (Panel B; Question 4).

Table 4 reveals two fundamental structural trends:

1. **The 10th Parliament (2014) Generational Crossover:** From 1973 to 2009 (1st–9th Parliaments), dynastic seats were numerically dominated by first-generation founders (54.1% to 90.7%). In the **10th Parliament (2014)**, biological mortality and dynastic succession produced a permanent structural crossover: second- and third-generation heirs (58/102 = 56.9%) outnumbered first-generation founders (43.1%) for the first time. Accelerated by the COVID-19 mortality wave among veteran MPs in 2020–2022, second- and third-generation heirs rose to 67.0% **(**77/115**) in the 11th Parliament**, 81.9% **(**68/83**) in the 12th Parliament**, and 81.5% **(**44/54**) in the post-revolutionary 13th Parliament (2026)** [18].
2. **The Ossification of Personal Incumbency (Question 4):** Panel B shows that Bangladesh's legislature progressively ossified into an entrenched incumbent club between 1991 and 2024: the share

Table 4: Generational Cohort Turnover and Personal Incumbency Persistence Across the 1st to 13th Parliaments (1973–2026)

		A. Dynastic Generational Turnover ($n = 1,014$)					B. Personal Seat Persistence ($N = 4,527$)		
Parliament	**Historical Era**	**Dyn. Seats**	**1st Gen.**	**2nd Gen.**	**3rd Gen.**	**2nd+3rd %**	**Mean Terms**	**Repeat (≥ 2)**	**Veteran (≥ 4)**
1st (1973–1975)	Founding Liberation Cohort	54	49	4	1	9.3%	1.00	0.0%	0.0%
2nd (1979–1982)	Zia Presidential Multi-Party	52	39	13	0	25.0%	1.12	11.6%	0.0%
3rd (1986–1987)	Ershad Hybrid (BNP Boycott)	57	35	21	1	38.6%	1.35	31.4%	0.0%
4th (1988–1990)	Ershad Boycotted Assembly	35	21	12	2	40.0%	1.63	47.5%	2.3%
5th (1991–1995)	Democratic Transition (CTG I)	87	65	20	2	25.3%	1.58	37.8%	4.3%
6th (Feb 1996)	13th Amendment Short Assembly	59	39	20	0	33.9%	1.81	55.8%	5.8%
7th (1996–2001)	Competitive Duopoly (CTG II)	110	79	29	2	28.2%	2.15	62.0%	12.0%
8th (2001–2006)	Four-Party Landslide (CTG III)	108	66	39	3	38.9%	**2.59**	**68.2%**	**30.7%**
9th (2009–2014)	Grand Alliance Wave (CTG IV)	98	53	39	6	45.9%	2.08	47.4%	16.3%
10th (2014–2019)	**Generational Crossover Point**	**102**	**44**	**51**	**7**	**56.9%**	2.22	59.9%	18.0%
11th (2019–2024)	Peak Dynastic Volume & COVID Wave	115	38	66	11	**67.0%**	**2.58**	**66.4%**	24.1%
12th (Jan–Aug 2024)	Pre-Revolution Dominant Assembly	83	15	60	8	**81.9%**	2.46	52.1%	26.5%
13th (2026–Present)	Post-Uprising 2nd-Gen. Restoration	54	10	40	4	**81.5%**	1.68	28.5%	11.4%
All Seat Records	**Cumulative Census (1973–2026)**	**1,014**	**553**	**414**	**47**	**45.5%**	**1.89**	**44.5%**	**12.2%**

of repeat MPs ($\geq$ 2 terms) rose from 37.8% in 1991 to 68.2% **in 2001** (where 30.7% **of the entire parliament consisted of** 4+ **term veterans**) and 66.4% **in 2019** (mean tenure = 2.58 parliaments), before the August 2024 revolution and February 2026 election reset repeat incumbency to 28.5%. Across all unique MPs in the 53-year census ($N = 2,713$ disambiguated individuals: 401 dynastic MPs and 2,312 non-dynastic MPs), 67.6% **(**1,563/2,312**) of non-dynastic MPs serve only a single parliamentary term**, whereas 62.1% **(**249/401**) of dynastic MPs serve two or more parliaments** (averaging 2.41 distinct parliaments and 2.53 seat wins vs. 1.50 parliaments for non-dynasts), and **dynastic MPs are** 3.66× **more likely to become** 4+ **term parliamentary veterans** (23.44% [94/401] vs. 6.40% [148/2,312]).

To test **Hypothesis 1 (MP Career Longevity)** and **Hypothesis 5 (Multi-Party Family Survival)** econometrically, Table 5 estimates multivariate regressions across all $N = 2,713$ unique MPs (401 canonical dynastic MPs and 2,312 non-dynastic MPs in Models H1a, H1b, and H3c, controlling for entry parliament cohort, party, and reserved seat status) and across all $N = 170$ political families (Models H5a and H5b).

Table 5: Econometric Models of MP Career Longevity ($N = 2,700$ Named Unique MPs; $N = 2,713$ Total Entries incl. 13 Vacant Placeholders) and Dynastic Family Survival ($N = 170$ Families)

	A. Unique MP Career Models ($N = 2,713$ Entries / 2,700 Named MPs)				B. Family Survival Models ($N = 170$ Families)
	Model H1a (OLS)	**Model H1b (LPM)**	**Model H3c (LPM)**	**Model H5a (OLS)**	**Model H5b (OLS)**
Explanatory Variable	*DV: Parls Served*	*DV: Veteran ($\geq$ 4 Parls)*	*DV: Career Cabinet*	*DV: Active Parls*	*DV: Active Parls*
Dynastic MP (Is_Dynastic$_i$)	**0.7898*** (0.0754)**	**0.1554*** (0.0210)**	**0.1136*** (0.0246)**	—	—
	($t = 10.48$, $p < 0.0001$)	($t = 7.41$, $p < 0.0001$)	($t = 4.62$, $p < 0.0001$)		
Total Parliaments Served (T_i)	—	—	**0.1398*** (0.0076)**	—	—
Ever Reserved Women's Seat	−0.3785*** (0.0389)	−0.0656*** (0.0093)	−0.0811*** (0.0161)	—	—
Multi-Party Family ($\geq$ 2 Parties)	—	—	—	**0.5922* (0.3441)**	+0.1889 (0.3107)
Family Network Size (Total_MPs$_f$)	—	—	—	—	**0.2740*** (0.0753)**
Family Ever in Cabinet (Cabinet$_f$)	—	—	—	—	**1.0490*** (0.2634)**
Founding Entry Parliament (First_Parl$_f$)	Cohort FE (12)	Cohort FE (12)	Cohort FE (12)	−0.2961*** (0.0421)	−0.2183*** (0.0405)
Party Fixed Effects (6 Blocs)	Yes	Yes	Yes	—	—
Observations (N) / R^2	2,713 / 0.2444	2,713 / 0.1506	2,713 / 0.2420	170 / 0.2408	170 / 0.4263

Notes: HC1 heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors in parentheses. *** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.10$. Unconditionally, multi-party families (60/170 = 35.29% across all party labels; 52/170 = 30.6% excluding Independents; 44/170 = 25.9% spanning $\geq$ 2 of AL, BNP, and JP) survive 5.38 vs. 4.15 parliaments ($t = 3.48$, $p = 0.0007$); controlling for entry cohort in Model H5a yields +0.59 parliaments ($t = 1.72$, $p = 0.085$), which is accounted for by family size and Cabinet access in Model H5b.

Table 5 confirms both H1 and H5: controlling for entry cohort and party across all 2,713 unique MPs, dynastic MPs serve +0.790 **additional parliaments** ($t = 10.48$, $p < 0.0001$), are +15.54 **percentage points more likely to become** 4+ **term veterans** ($t = 7.41$, $p < 0.0001$), and are +11.36 **percentage points more likely to attain Cabinet office over their lifetime** ($t = 4.62$, $p < 0.0001$) even after controlling for total parliaments served ($\hat{\beta} = +0.1398$, $t = 18.32$, $p < 0.0001$). Across the 170 families (Panel B), multi-party diversification is associated with higher family survival unconditionally (5.38 vs. 4.15 parliaments, $p = 0.0007$; +0.59 parliaments, $t = 1.72$, $p = 0.085$ controlling for entry cohort in Model H5a), while Model H5b shows how family scale and executive access account for this relationship: multi-party families survive longer because placing relatives across rival parties expands the family's MP count ($\beta = +0.274$, $t = 3.64$) and secures executive Cabinet protection ($\beta = +1.049$, $t = 3.98$, $p = 0.0001$), which adds more than a full parliamentary term to the family's institutional lifespan.

6 Econometric Analysis of Executive Gatekeeping and Sovereign Portfolio Capture (RQ1 / H3)

Table 6 cross-tabulates Cabinet appointment (`In_Cabinet`) and Senior Executive appointment (`Full_Minister`) across all $N = 4,527$ seat records by exact cumulative parliamentary seniority (Tenure$_{i,t} \in \{1, 2, 3, 4+\}$). Table 7 presents our baseline LPM and Logit models, and Table 8 executes our six-model **Step 2 Econometric Robustness Suite**.

Table 6: The Executive Gatekeeping Premium by Exact Parliamentary Seniority ($N = 4,527$ Seat Records, 1973–2026)

	Dynastic MPs ($n = 1,014$)			Non-Dynastic MPs ($n = 3,513$)			Dynastic Premium Ratio	
Parliamentary Seniority Tier	**Seats (n)**	**Any Cabinet (%)**	**Full Min./PM (%)**	**Seats (n)**	**Any Cabinet (%)**	**Full Min./PM (%)**	**Any Cabinet**	**Full Min./PM**
1st-Term MPs (Freshmen)	453	41.72%	29.58%	2,057	15.70%	7.63%	**2.66×**	**3.88×**
2nd-Term MPs	246	54.47%	40.65%	708	29.94%	15.25%	**1.82×**	**2.66×**
3rd-Term MPs	147	68.71%	53.06%	365	42.47%	22.19%	**1.62×**	**2.39×**
4+ Term Senior MPs	168	83.93%	71.43%	383	53.79%	31.85%	**1.56×**	**2.24×**
All Seat Records (1973–2026)	**1,014**	**55.72%**	**42.60%**	**3,513**	**25.51%**	**13.32%**	**2.18×**	**3.20×**

Figure 2: The Executive Gatekeeping Funnel Across the Five-Tier Hierarchy (Table A3) and the Freshman Fast-Track (Table 6)

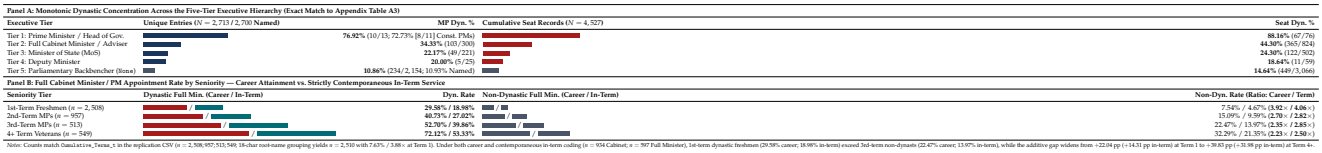


Table 7: Baseline Econometric Estimates of the Dynastic Cabinet Premium (LPM and Logit with HC1 Robust Standard Errors, $N = 4,527$)

	Model 1A (LPM)	**Model 1B (Logit)**	**Model 1C (LPM)**	**Model 1D (Logit)**	**Model 1E (LPM)**
	DV: Any Cabinet	*DV: Any Cabinet*	*DV: Full Minister/PM*	*DV: Full Minister/PM*	*DV: Full Min. | In Cabinet*
Explanatory Variable	**Coef. (HC1 SE)**	**Logit [Odds Ratio]**	**Coef. (HC1 SE)**	**Logit [Odds Ratio]**	**Coef. (HC1 SE)**
Dynastic MP (Is_Dynastic$_i$)	**0.2457*** (0.0168)**	**1.2020*** [OR = 3.33]**	**0.2586*** (0.0160)**	**1.5439*** [OR = 4.68]**	**0.2366*** (0.0242)**
	($t = 14.65, p < 0.0001$)	($z = 14.77, p < 0.0001$)	($t = 16.14, p < 0.0001$)	($z = 17.25, p < 0.0001$)	($t = 9.76, p < 0.0001$)
Cumulative Tenure (Terms$_{i,t}$)	**0.1015*** (0.0059)**	**0.5211*** [OR = 1.68]**	**0.0829*** (0.0053)**	**0.5254*** [OR = 1.69]**	**0.0645*** (0.0090)**
	($t = 17.16, p < 0.0001$)	($z = 14.98, p < 0.0001$)	($t = 15.59, p < 0.0001$)	($z = 15.20, p < 0.0001$)	($t = 7.14, p < 0.0001$)
Reserved Women's Seat	−0.1543*** (0.0166)	−1.1541*** [OR = 0.32]	−0.1126*** (0.0107)	−2.0921*** [OR = 0.12]	−0.3723*** (0.0572)
Party Fixed Effects (6 Blocs)	Yes (Ref: AL)	Yes (Ref: AL)	Yes (Ref: AL)	Yes (Ref: AL)	Yes (Ref: AL)
Parliament Fixed Effects (1st–13th)	Yes (12 Dummies)	Yes (12 Dummies)	Yes (12 Dummies)	Yes (12 Dummies)	Yes (12 Dummies)
Observations (N)	4,527	4,527	4,527	4,527	1,461
R^2 / Pseudo-R^2	0.1973	0.1701	0.1867	0.1929	0.1251

Together, Tables 6, 7, and 8—visualized in Figures 2 and 3—establish five landmark findings for comparative legislative and executive studies:

1. **The** 4.06× **In-Term (**3.92× **Career) Freshman Executive Fast-Track (Table 6):** Among first-term freshman MPs (`Cumulative_Terms_t`$= 1, n = 2,508$: 453 dynastic, 2,055 non-dynastic; or $n = 2,510$ under 18-character root-name grouping), dynastic novices attain contemporaneous in-term Cabinet posts at 26.05% **vs.** 9.05% (2.88×; career: 41.94% vs. 15.52%) and contemporaneous Full Cabinet Ministries at 18.98% **vs.** 4.67% (4.06×; career: 29.58% vs. 7.54%, 3.92×, or 7.63% / 3.88× under $n = 2,510$). Under both contemporaneous and career coding, a first-term dynastic MP has a higher probability of becoming a Full Cabinet Minister (18.98% in-term; 29.58% career) than a third-term non-dynastic MP (13.97% in-term; 22.47% career).

2. **Multi-Way Clustered Econometric Equivalence to** 2.42–3.12 **Terms of Seniority (Tables 7 & 8):** Controlling for cumulative tenure, reserved seat status, party fixed effects, and parliament fixed effects, dynastic status increases Cabinet appointment probability by +24.57 **percentage points** ($t_{\text{HC1}} = 14.65$, family-clustered $t_{\text{fam}} = 7.98$, constituency-clustered $t_{\text{const}} = 9.63$, $p < 0.0001$; Logit OR = 3.33) and Full Ministerial probability by +25.86 **percentage points** ($t_{\text{HC1}} = 16.14$,

Table 8: Step 2 Econometric Robustness Suite: Clustered SEs, Sovereign Portfolios, Seniority Interactions, and Regime-Era Sub-Samples

Panel A: Full-Sample Clustered, Sovereign Portfolio, and Interaction Models ($N = 4,527$)						
Variable / Specification	Model 2A *DV: Any Cabinet* Family-Clust. SE	Model 2B *DV: Any Cabinet* Comb.-Clust. SE	Model 2C *DV: Full Min.95H* Family-Clust. SE	Model 2D *DV: Sovereign Min.* Family-Clust. SE	Model 2E *DV: Any Cabinet* Interaction (Fam. SE)	Model 2F *DV: Full Min.95H* Interaction (Fam. SE)
Dynastic MP (Ex_Dynastic_i)	0.2457*** (0.0308) ($t = 7.98$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.2457*** (0.0255) ($t = 9.64$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.2586*** (0.0349) ($t = 7.40$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1891*** (0.0316) ($t = 5.98$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.2272*** (0.0322) ($t = 7.06$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.2044*** (0.0318) ($p = 6.40$, $p < 0.0001$)
Tenure (Terms$_{i,t}$) or Terms$_{i,t}$ = 0	0.3313*** (0.0093)	0.3313*** (0.0079)	0.0439*** (0.0092)	0.0412*** (0.0078)	0.0977*** (0.0122)	0.0697*** (0.0102)
Dynastic MP × Tenure$_{i,t}$					−0.0332*** (0.0147)	+0.0307*** (0.0127)
Removed Seat + Party & Fed. FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Clusters (G) / R^2	2,190 / 0.1872	345 / 0.1975	2,190 / 0.1867	2,190 / 0.1112	2,190 / 0.1975	2,190 / 0.1918
Panel B: Sub-Sample Regressions Across Institutional Regime Eras (Family-Clustered Standard Errors)						
	Era 1: Military Qasi-Mix, $N = 971$)		Era 2: Caretaker (5th,7th–9th, $N = 1,450$)		Era 3: Dominant (10th–12th)	Era 4: Post-Rev. (13th)
Sub-Sample Parameter	*Any Cabinet*	*Full Min.95H*	*Any Cabinet*	*Full Min.95H*	*Full Min. ($N = 1,108$)*	*Any Cab. ($N = 351$)*
Dynastic MP (Ex_Dynastic_i)	0.4021*** (0.0478) ($p = 8.41$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.3999*** (0.0510) ($t = 7.85$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.2317*** (0.0458) ($t = 5.06$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.2556*** (0.0514) ($t = 4.25$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1048** (0.0402) ($t = 2.61$, $p = 0.0093$)	0.3306*** (0.0751) ($p = 4.40$, $p < 0.0001$)
Cumulative Tenure (Terms$_{i,t}$)	0.1309*** (0.0327)	0.1444*** (0.0290)	0.0867*** (0.0148)	0.0751*** (0.0144)	0.0277** (0.0108)	0.0344* (0.0175)
Clusters (G) / R^2	715 / 0.1748	715 / 0.1964	838 / 0.0743	838 / 0.1923	619 / 0.2040	339 / 0.1972
Panel C: Identification & Measurement Hardening — Strictly Term-Specific Cabinet ($\text{Cabinet_In_Term}_i = 934$), Freshmen ($N = 2,508$) & Deduplicated ($N = 4,389$)						
	Model 3A (Term) *DV: Term Cabinet* All ($N = 4,527$)	Model 3B (Term) *DV: Term Full Min.* All ($N = 4,527$)	Model 3C ($T = 1$) *DV: Career Cab.* Freshmen ($N = 2,508$)	Model 3D ($T = 1$) *DV: Term Cabinet* Freshmen ($N = 2,508$)	Model 3E (Dedup.) *DV: Career Cab.* 1 Seat/MP-Parl ($N = 4,389$)	Model 3F (Dedup.) *DV: Term Cabinet* 1 Seat/MP-Parl ($N = 4,389$)
Dynastic MP (Ex_Dynastic_i)	0.1928*** (0.0237) ($p = 8.14$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1949*** (0.0256) ($t = 7.60$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.2400*** (0.0290) ($t = 8.29$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1678*** (0.0234) ($t = 7.17$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.2264*** (0.0293) ($t = 7.66$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1772*** (0.0217) ($t = 8.18$, $p < 0.0001$)
Clusters (G) / R^2	2,482 / 0.1303	2,482 / 0.1323	2,211 / 0.1402	2,211 / 0.0946	2,451 / 0.1945	2,451 / 0.1945
Panel D: Endogeneity, Risk-Set & Kinship Hardening on Contemporaneous In-Term Cabinet (DV: Cabinet_In_Term_i)						
Endogeneity Specification	Model 4A (Core 2+) *Predetermined Heirs* All ($N = 4,527$)	Model 4B (Core 3+ [T = 1]) *Heir Freshmen (Fed 2–12)* No Core 1 ($N = 2,103$)	Model 4C (Core, Risk) *Ruling Coal. Excl. PMs* Risk Set ($N = 3,594$)	Model 4D ($T \times$ Pl) *Party × Parl. FE* Named ($N = 4,514$)	Model 4E (No Top-3) *Drop FAM-001/002/003 PMs* No Mega ($N = 4,319$)	Model 4F (Sat-Dup.) *Consanguineal Blood* No Affinal ($N = 4,320$)
Dynastic / Inheritor ($\psi_{i,t}$)	0.2203*** (0.0279) ($t = 7.89$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1728*** (0.0314) ($t = 5.51$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1960*** (0.0243) ($t = 8.07$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1981*** (0.0235) ($t = 8.44$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1746*** (0.0245) ($t = 7.14$, $p < 0.0001$)	0.1944*** (0.0270) ($p = 7.19$, $p < 0.0001$)
Clusters (G) / R^2	2,482 / 0.1311	1,906 / 0.0833	2,115 / 0.1367	2,469 / 0.1650	2,464 / 0.1161	2,436 / 0.1246

Notes: Panel A clusters on normalized seat names ($G = 2,190$); clustering on exact disambiguated primary family IDs ($G = 2,482$, 338 families; 1,922 non-dynasts, 1,407 named) yields SE = 0.0308 ($t = 7.98$, $p < 0.0001$). Panel B: Era 1: Military Qasi-Mix (1973–90), $N = 971$, $G = 715$; Era 2: Caretaker (5th, 7th–9th), $N = 1,450$, $G = 838$; Era 3: Dominant (10th–12th), $N = 1,108$, $G = 639$; Era 4: Post-Revolution 13th Parliament (2026), $N = 351$, $G = 339$. Panel C: Model 3A: Cabinet$_{i,t}$ = Term Cabinet, All, $N = 4,527$, $G = 2,482$; Model 3B: Full Min.95H$_{i,t}$ = Term Full Min., All, $N = 4,527$, $G = 2,482$; Model 3C: $T = 1$, Career Cab., Freshmen, $N = 2,508$, $G = 2,211$; Model 3D: $T = 1$, Term Cabinet, Freshmen, $N = 2,508$, $G = 2,211$; Model 3E (Dedup.): Career Cab., 1 Seat/MP-Parl, $N = 4,389$, $G = 2,451$; Model 3F (Dedup.): Term Cabinet, 1 Seat/MP-Parl, $N = 4,389$, $G = 2,451$. Panel D: Model 4A (Core 2+): Predetermined Heirs, All, $N = 4,527$, $G = 2,482$; Model 4B (Core 3+ [T = 1]): Heir Freshmen (Fed 2–12), No Core 1, $N = 2,103$, $G = 1,906$; Model 4C (Core, Risk): Ruling Coal. Excl. PMs, Risk Set, $N = 3,594$, $G = 2,115$; Model 4D ($T \times$ Pl): Party × Parl. FE, Named, $N = 4,514$, $G = 2,469$; Model 4E (No Top-3): Drop FAM-001/002/003 PMs, No Mega, $N = 4,319$, $G = 2,464$; Model 4F (Sat-Dup.): Consanguineal Blood, No Affinal, $N = 4,320$, $G = 2,436$. Model 3E: 1 Seat/MP-Parl (Dedup.) yields -0.1949 ($t = -7.92$) and -0.1741 ($t = -7.54$); Model 3F: 1 Seat/MP-Parl (Dedup.) yields $+0.0307$ ($t = 2.41$, $p = 0.0093$) and $+0.0344$ ($t = 1.97$, $p = 0.0488$). Model 3E–F collapse simultaneous multi-constituency wins ($N = 4,389$).

Figure 3: Econometric Coefficient Forest Plot Across 17 Specifications: Career, Contemporaneous In-Term, Predetermined 2nd/3rd-Gen Heirs, Governing Risk Set, and Regime Eras

Model & Identification Specification	Sample / Clustering	$\hat{\beta}_{\text{Dynastic}}$ (SE)	t-Stat	Magnitude Bar (Percentage Points)
Model 1A / 2A: Career Any Cabinet (Baseline LPM)	$N = 4,527$ ($G = 2,190$)	$+0.2457^{***}$ (0.0308)	7.98	+24.6 pp
Model 1C / 2C: Career Full Minister/PM	$N = 4,527$ ($G = 2,190$)	$+0.2586^{***}$ (0.0349)	7.40	+25.9 pp
Model 2D: High-Rent Sovereign Ministry	$N = 4,527$ ($G = 2,190$)	$+0.1891^{***}$ (0.0316)	5.98	+18.9 pp
Model 3A (Panel C): Strictly Contemporaneous In-Term Cabinet (CSV $n = 934$)	$N = 4,527$ ($G = 2,482$)	$+0.1928^{***}$ (0.0237)	8.14	+19.3 pp
Model 3B (Panel C): Strictly Contemporaneous In-Term Full Min. (CSV $n = 597$)	$N = 4,527$ ($G = 2,482$)	$+0.1949^{***}$ (0.0256)	7.60	+19.5 pp
Model 3D (Panel C): First-Term Freshmen Only ($T = 1$, In-Term Cab.)	$N = 2,508$ ($G = 2,211$)	$+0.1678^{***}$ (0.0234)	7.17	+16.8 pp
Model 3F (Panel C): Multi-Seat Deduplicated 1 Seat/MP-Parl (In-Term)	$N = 4,389$ ($G = 2,451$)	$+0.1772^{***}$ (0.0217)	8.18	+17.7 pp
Model 4A (Panel D): Predetermined 2nd/3rd-Gen Heirs Only (In-Term Cab.)	$N = 4,527$ ($G = 2,482$)	$+0.2203^{***}$ (0.0279)	7.89	+22.0 pp
Model 4B (Panel D): 2nd/3rd-Gen Freshmen Excl. 1st Parl (In-Term Cab.)	$N = 2,001$ ($G = 1,906$)	$+0.1728^{***}$ (0.0314)	5.51	+17.3 pp
Model 4C (Panel D): Governing-Coalition Risk Set Excl. PMs (In-Term)	$N = 3,594$ ($G = 2,115$)	$+0.1960^{***}$ (0.0243)	8.07	+19.6 pp
Model 4D (Panel D): Party × Parliament Interactive FE (In-Term)	$N = 4,514$ ($G = 2,469$)	$+0.1981^{***}$ (0.0235)	8.44	+19.8 pp
Model 4E (Panel D): Leave-Out Top 3 Families FAM-001/002/003 (In-Term)	$N = 4,319$ ($G = 2,464$)	$+0.1746^{***}$ (0.0245)	7.14	+17.5 pp
Model 4F (Panel D): Consanguineal First-Degree Blood Kin Only (In-Term)	$N = 4,320$ ($G = 2,436$)	$+0.1944^{***}$ (0.0270)	7.19	+19.4 pp
Panel B Era 1: Military Regimes (2nd–4th Parls, 1979–1990)	$N = 971$ ($G = 715$)	$+0.4021^{***}$ (0.0478)	8.41	+40.2 pp
Panel B Era 2: Caretaker Democracy (5th, 7th–9th Parls)	$N = 1,450$ ($G = 838$)	$+0.2317^{***}$ (0.0458)	5.06	+23.2 pp
Panel B Era 3: Dominant-Party Era (10th–12th Parls, Full Min.)	$N = 1,108$ ($G = 639$)	$+0.1048^{***}$ (0.0402)	2.61	+10.5 pp
Panel B Era 4: Post-Revolution 13th Parliament (2026)	$N = 351$ ($G = 339$)	$+0.3306^{***}$ (0.0751)	4.40	+33.1 pp

Notes: All 17 specifications are statistically significant at $p < 0.01$ (***). Notice that restricting strictly to predetermined 2nd/3rd-generation heirs (Model 4A, +22.0 pp), governing-coalition MPs excluding PMs (Model 4C, +19.6 pp), or Party × Parliament FE (Model 4D, +19.8 pp) strengthens the contemporaneous estimate.

$t_{\text{fam}} = 7.40$, $p < 0.0001$; Logit OR $= 4.68$). Dividing the dynastic coefficient by the seniority slope (β_1/β_2) shows that dynastic lineage is econometrically equivalent to 2.42 **parliamentary terms** (delta-method 95% CI: ± 0.43 under HC1, ± 0.74 under family clustering) for any Cabinet post and 3.12 **parliamentary terms** (95% CI: ± 0.54 HC1, ± 1.07 family-clustered) for a Full Cabinet Ministry.

3. **Capture of High-Rent Sovereign Ministries (Model 2D):** Dynastic MPs capture 45.42% **(**332/731**)** of all high-rent sovereign and infrastructural portfolios (Finance, Home, Foreign, Defence, LGRD, Communications/Road Transport, Power/Energy, Commerce, Industries, Law, Planning, Education, and Water Resources), with a family-clustered regression premium of +18.91 **percentage points** ($t_{\text{fam}} = 5.98$, $p = 2.2 \times 10^{-9}$).

4. **Invariance Across All Four Regime Eras (Panel B of Table 8):** Whether under military autocracy (+40.21 pp, $t = 8.41$), competitive Caretaker democracy (+23.17 pp any Cabinet; +29.56 pp Full Minister, $t = 5.75$), dominant-party hegemony (+10.48 pp Full Minister, $t = 2.61$), or the post-revolutionary 13th Parliament in 2026 (+33.06 pp, $t = 4.40$), prime ministers and presidents consistently privilege dynastic MPs when forming Cabinets.

5. **Identification Hardening Across Strictly Term-Specific Portfolios, First-Term Freshmen, and Deduplicated Multi-Seat Winners (Table 8, Panel C):** Because career-level executive attainment coding ($\text{Cabinet}_{i,t}^{\text{Career}}$) could reflect either future portfolio appointments after t or past portfolios held during opposition terms, Panel C constructs strictly contemporaneous term-specific executive indicators directly in the replication CSV (`Cabinet_In_Term`, $n = 934$, 381 dynastic [40.79%]; `Full_Minister_In_Term`, $n = 597$, 300 dynastic [50.25%]) coded 1 when MP i's documented portfolio service dates match Parliament t. Under exact family/individual clustering ($G = 2,482$: 170 dynasties +2,312 non-dynast entry IDs; $G = 2,469$ strictly named), the contemporaneous dynastic premium is +19.28 **percentage points** (SE $= 0.0237$, $t = 8.14$, $p < 0.0001$) for any Cabinet post (Model 3A) and +19.49 **percentage points** (SE $= 0.0256$, $t = 7.60$, $p < 0.0001$) for Full Ministries (Model 3B) (and +17.00 pp, $t = 7.52$ / +17.41 pp, $t = 7.34$, OR $= 4.10\times$ under an alternative boundary-year governing-coalition filter with $n = 935$ Cabinet [362 dynastic] and $n = 585$ Full Minister [280 dynastic]). Restricting solely to first-term freshmen (`Cumulative_Terms_t`$= 1$, $N = 2,508$, $G = 2,211$) eliminates endogenous multi-term survival bias and yields +24.04 **percentage points** ($t = 8.29$, Model 3C) and +16.78 **percentage points** ($t = 7.17$, Model 3D), while collapsing simultaneous multi-constituency wins to one observation per MP per parliament ($N = 4,389$, $G = 2,451$) yields +22.46 **percentage points** ($t = 7.66$, Model 3E) and +17.72

percentage points ($t = 8.18$, Model 3F). Furthermore, **Panel D (Models 4A–4F)** resolves six potential endogeneity and risk-set concerns on the strictly contemporaneous in-term Cabinet outcome: (i) separating **predetermined 2nd/3rd-generation inheritors** (Gen 2+, $n = 461$ seats, whose dynastic lineage is fixed prior to political entry) from 1st-generation founders ($n = 553$) shows that predetermined heirs enjoy an even larger contemporaneous Cabinet premium of $+22.03$ **percentage points** ($t = 7.89$, Model 4A; $+26.74$ pp career, $t = 7.47$) than 1st-generation founders ($+17.01$ pp, $t = 5.31$); (ii) restricting to **first-term 2nd/3rd-generation inheritor freshmen in Parliaments 2–13** (dropping the 1973 founding assembly and all 1st-generation founders, $N = 2,001$) yields $+17.28$ **percentage points** ($t = 5.51$, Model 4B; $+25.52$ pp career, $t = 6.62$); (iii) restricting the estimation sample strictly to **governing-coalition MPs eligible for ministerial appointment while dropping all Tier-1 Prime Ministers/principals** ($N = 3,594$) raises the contemporaneous premium to $+19.60$ **percentage points** ($t = 8.07$, Model 4C); (iv) saturating the specification with **Party $\times$ Parliament interactive fixed effects** ($N = 4,514$) yields $+19.81$ **percentage points** ($t = 8.44$, Model 4D); (v) **dropping the three national leadership dynasties (`FAM-001`, `FAM-002`, `FAM-003`) and all Tier-1 PMs** ($N = 4,319$) yields $+17.46$ **percentage points** ($t = 7.14$, Model 4E); and (vi) restricting strictly to **consanguineal first-degree blood kin** (excluding affinal in-laws, $N = 4,320$) yields $+19.44$ **percentage points** ($t = 7.19$, Model 4F). Direct behavioral testing of the loyalty mechanism ($\Delta_{\text{def}} > 0$ in Equation 1) across all $n = 883$ multi-term MPs confirms that non-dynastic multi-term MPs defect across major parties at 17.19% (23.03% any switch), compared to 11.24% for dynastic MPs and just 10.08% for 2nd/3rd-generation dynastic inheritors. Finally, to eliminate post-treatment tenure control altogether, we estimate **discrete-time event-history hazard models** (both complementary log-log proportional hazards [`cloglog`, the exact discrete-time analog of the Cox proportional hazards model] and discrete-time LPM with baseline spell-duration dummies $\tau \in \{1, 2, 3, 4+\}$, party fixed effects, and parliament fixed effects, clustered on $G = 2,469$ exact person/family clusters) tracking each named MP from initial parliamentary entry ($\tau = 1$) across $N = 3,847$ at-risk MP–parliament spells until their **first contemporaneous in-term Cabinet appointment** (or across $N = 4,044$ spells until their **first in-term Full Ministerial appointment**), alongside a **competing-risk backbench exit hazard model** ($N = 4,082$ spells in Parliaments 1–12):

- **Time-to-First In-Term Any Cabinet Hazard ($N = 3,847$ spells, 499 first appointments):** Dynastic MPs exhibit a complementary log-log **Hazard Ratio of HR** $= 2.12\times$ ($\hat{\beta} = +0.7520, \text{SE} = 0.1071, z = 7.02, p < 0.0001$; discrete-time LPM hazard $+10.95$ pp per spell, SE $= 0.0180, t = 6.09$). Separating predetermined 2nd/3rd-generation inheritors from 1st-generation founders shows that **predetermined 2nd/3rd-generation heirs achieve an even higher Hazard Ratio of HR** $= 2.32\times$ ($z = 6.35, p < 0.0001$; LPM $+11.94$ pp, $t = 5.28$) compared to HR $= 1.97\times$ ($z = 5.06$) for 1st-generation founders.
- **Time-to-First In-Term Full Minister/PM Hazard ($N = 4,044$ spells, 283 first appointments):** Dynastic MPs exhibit a **Hazard Ratio of HR** $= 2.75\times$ ($\hat{\beta} = +1.0113, \text{SE} = 0.1385, z = 7.30, p < 0.0001$; LPM hazard $+8.69$ pp, $t = 5.85$), with **predetermined 2nd/3rd-generation heirs reaching HR** $= 3.11\times$ ($z = 6.57, p < 0.0001$; LPM $+9.12$ pp, $t = 5.02$).
- **Competing-Risk Backbench Exit / Attrition Hazard ($N = 4,082$ spells, Parliaments 1–12):** Per parliamentary spell, non-dynastic MPs suffer a 63.25% permanent career exit rate compared to 38.16% for dynastic MPs—yielding a controlled exit hazard reduction of -20.84 **percentage points** (SE $= 0.0163, t = -12.81, p < 0.0001$) and a complementary log-log **Exit Hazard Ratio of HR** $= 0.48\times$ ($z = -10.59, p < 0.0001$).

7 The Anatomy of Endurance: Longest-Serving Individuals, Dominant Families, and Stronghold Constituencies (Questions 5, 6 & 7)

7.1 The Top 7 Individuals, Top 7 Longest-Active Families, and Top 5 Families by Unique MPs (Questions 5 & 6)

Table 9 documents the exact empirical records across our 53-year census for (A) the **Top 7 dynastic individuals** holding parliamentary and executive power for the longest time, (B) the **Top 7 non-dynastic multi-term veterans** (verified free of homonym collisions), (C) the **Top 7 political families** holding power across the greatest number of parliaments and seat wins, and (D) the **Top 5 political families** placing the largest number of distinct individuals (unique MPs) in power.

Table 9: The Apex of Longevity and Family Size: Top 7 Individuals, Top 7 Families by Longevity, and Top 5 Families by Unique MPs (1973–2026)

Panel A: Top 7 Dynastic Individuals by Distinct Parliaments Served (Plus Multi-Seat Prime Ministerial Records)

Rank	Canonical Name (`Family_ID`)	Parls	Seat Wins	Highest Rank	Parliaments Served & Key Constituencies
1	**Sheikh Fazlul Karim Selim** (`FAM-001`)	**9**	9	Cabinet Minister	2nd, 3rd, 5th, 7th–12th (1979–2024; *Faridpur-10 / Gopalganj-2*)
2	**Sheikh Hasina** (`FAM-001`)	**8**	**16**	Prime Minister (5x)	3rd, 5th, 7th–12th (1986–2024; *Gopalganj-3, Rangpur-6, Bagerhat-1*)
3	**Anwar Hossain Manju** (`FAM-069`)	7	8	Cabinet Minister	3rd, 4th, 5th, 7th, 8th, 10th, 11th (1986–2024; *Pirojpur-2*)
4	**Major (retd.) Hafiz Uddin Ahmad** (`FAM-016`)	7	7	Cabinet Minister	3rd, 4th, 5th, 6th, 7th, 8th, 13th (1986–2026; 40-yr span in *Bhola-3*)
5	**Suranjit Sengupta** (`FAM-121`)	7	7	Cabinet Minister	2nd, 3rd, 5th, 7th, 8th, 9th, 10th (1979–2017; *Sunamganj-2*; +1970 MPA)
6	**Noor-E-Alam Chowdhury Liton** (`FAM-001`)	7	7	Cabinet Min. (Chief Whip)	5th, 7th, 8th, 9th, 10th, 11th, 12th (1991–2024; *Madaripur-1*)
7	**Md. Dabirul Islam** (`FAM-017`) / **Abdul Hamid** (`FAM-008`)*	7 / 6	7 / 6	MP / President & Speaker	Dabirul: 3rd, 5th, 7th–11th (*Thakurgaon-2*); Hamid: 1st, 3rd, 5th, 7th–9th + Pres.
Ref.	**Begum Khaleda Zia** (`FAM-002`) & **H. M. Ershad** (`FAM-003`)	5	**24 / 15**	Prime Minister / President	Khaleda Zia: **24 seat wins** (unbeaten in 5th–9th); Ershad: **15 seat wins** (5th–11th)

Panel B: Top 7 Non-Dynastic Multi-Term Veterans (Zero Homonym Collisions, Single-Constituency Root Verified)

1–4 **Tofail Ahmed** (*Bhola-1/2*: **8 Parls**, 10 seat wins, 1st, 3rd, 5th, 7th, 9th–12th, Cabinet Minister); **A. S. M. Feroz** (*Patuakhali-2*: **8 Parls**, 2nd, 3rd, 5th, 7th, 9th–12th, Chief Whip); **Mostafizur Rahman Fizar** (*Dinajpur-5*: **8 Parls**, 3rd, 5th, 7th–12th, Minister); **Shajahan Khan** (*Madaripur-2*: **8 Parls**, 3rd, 5th, 7th–12th, Minister).
5–7 **Barrister Anisul Islam Mahmud** (*Chittagong-5*: **7 Parls**, 2nd–4th, 9th–12th, Minister); **Bir Bahadur Ushwe Sing** (*Bandarban*: **7 Parls**, 5th, 7th–12th, Minister); **Imran Ahmad** (*Sylhet-4*: **7 Parls**, 3rd, 5th, 7th, 9th–12th, Minister) [tied with **Mirza Azam** & **Adv. Fazle Rabbi Miah** at 7 Parls].

Panel C: Top 7 Families Holding Power for the Longest Time (By Active Parliaments & Total Seat Wins, 1973–2026)

Rank	Family ID & Canonical Dynasty Name	Active Parls	Seat Wins	Cab. Terms	Span & Core Power Holders
1	`FAM-001` Tungipara Sheikh, Serniabat, Chowdhury & Wazed Dynasty	**12 / 13**	**102**	**64**	1st–5th, 7th–13th (1973–2026; Mujib, Hasina, Selim, Hasanat, Liton, Partho)
2	`FAM-003` Ershad–Quader Family (Jatiya Party Dynasty)	**11 / 13**	**41**	**31**	1st–5th, 7th–12th (1973–2024; Ershad, Rowshan, GM Quader, Bhola Miah)
3	`FAM-145` Raozan Chowdhury, Salman F. Rahman & Saber Hossain Network	**10 / 13**	**22**	**13**	2nd, 3rd, 5th, 7th–13th (1979–2026; Salahuddin Quader, Fazle Karim, Hummam)
4	`FAM-150` Akhtaruzzaman Babu, Sarwar Nizam & Saifuzzaman Javed Family	**10 / 13**	**11**	4	1st, 5th–13th across AL & BNP (*Chittagong-12/13*)
5	`FAM-006` Captain M. Mansur Ali Family (1975 PM Dynasty)	**9 / 13**	**11**	7	1st, 3rd, 5th, 7th–12th (*Sirajganj-1/2*: Mansur Ali, Selim, Nasim, Joy)
6	`FAM-159` Speaker Justice Abdul Jabbar Khan, Menon & Selima Rahman	**9 / 13**	**11**	**10**	2nd, 5th, 6th, 8th–13th across Left (WP) & BNP (Menon, Selima Rahman)
7	`FAM-002` Majumder–Zia Family (Ziaur Rahman, Khaleda Zia & Tarique Rahman)**	**6 + Pres.**	**32**	**28**	Pres. Zia (1977–81) + 5th–9th, 13th Parls (32 seats; 4 PM terms: Khaleda & Tarique)

Panel D: Top 5 Political Families with the Most Distinct People (Unique MPs) in Power

1	`FAM-001` **Tungipara Sheikh, Serniabat, Chowdhury & Wazed Dynasty**	**31 Unique MPs** (102 seat wins; 17 individuals in Cabinet; 3 Generations: Mujib, Hasina, Selim, Taposh, Liton, Nixon, Partho, etc.)
2	`FAM-003` **Ershad–Quader Family (Jatiya Party Dynasty)**	**13 Unique MPs** (41 seat wins; 6 individuals in Cabinet: H. M. Ershad, Rowshan, Saad, GM Quader, Sharifa, Bhola Miah, Mamta Wahab, etc.)
3	`FAM-145` **Raozan Chowdhury, Salman F. Rahman & Saber Hossain Network**	**6 Unique MPs** (22 seat wins: Salahuddin Quader, Giasuddin Quader, Hummam Quader, A. B. M. Fazle Karim, Salman F. Rahman, Saber Hossain)
4	`FAM-002` **Majumder–Zia Family (Khaleda Zia & Tarique Rahman Dynasty)**	**5 Unique MPs** (32 seat wins + Pres. Zia: Begum Khaleda Zia, PM Tarique Rahman, Minister Khurshid Jahan Haque, Sayeed Iskander, Shahrin Tuhin)
5	`FAM-113` **Osman Family of Narayanganj (Khan Sahib Osman Ali Dynasty)**	**5 Unique MPs** (13 seat wins across 8 Parls: A. K. M. Samsuzzoha, Nasim Osman, Shamim Osman, Salim Osman, Sarah Begum Kabori) [Followed at **4 MPs** by `FAM-005` Tajuddin Ahmad Family, `FAM-006` Capt. Mansur Ali Family, and `FAM-090` Mymensingh Khan Chowdhury Family].

*Notes: In Panel A, Col. (retd.) Oli Ahmad (`FAM-151`) also won 8 seats across 6 Parliaments. In Panel C, families are ordered by cumulative seat wins among long-serving dynasties; `FAM-008` (Pres. Abdul Hamid, 9 active Parls, 10 seats) and `FAM-121` (Sengupta, 9 active Parls, 10 seats) tie for 9 active parliaments.

Examining the micro-foundations of Table 9 highlights how individual and familial endurance interlock:

- **Individual Longevity Champions (Panels A & B):** Among dynastic legislators, **Sheikh Fazlul Karim Selim (`FAM-001`)** holds the all-time record of **9 distinct parliaments served** (1979–2024, winning `Faridpur-10` in the 2nd Parliament and `Gopalganj-2` in the 3rd, 5th, and 7th–12th Parliaments), followed by **Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina (`FAM-001`)** with **8 parliaments and 16 seat wins**, and five 7-parliament dynastic titans: **Anwar Hossain Manju (`FAM-069`)** in `Pirojpur-2`, **Major (retd.) Hafiz Uddin Ahmad (`FAM-016`)** spanning 40 years (1986–2026) in `Bhola-3`, **Suranjit Sengupta (`FAM-121`)** in `Sunamganj-2`, **Chief Whip Noor-E-Alam Chowdhury Liton (`FAM-001`)** in `Madaripur-1`, and **Md. Dabirul Islam (`FAM-017`)** in `Thakurgaon-2` (alongside **President Mohammad Abdul Hamid [`FAM-008`]**, who won 6 parliamentary terms in our roster plus the 1970 MNA election and served two terms as President of Bangladesh from 2013 to 2023). In terms of total constituency victories via multi-seat candidacy, **Begum Khaleda Zia (`FAM-002`)** stands first in Bangladeshi history with **24 parliamentary seat wins across 5 parliaments** without ever losing a single election (`Bogra-6`, `Bogra-7`, `Feni-1`, `Lakshmipur-2`, `Chittagong-1`, `Khulna-2`, etc.), followed by **Sheikh Hasina (16 seat wins)** and **H. M. Ershad (15 seat wins)**.
- **Family Network Scale and Multi-Generational Reach (Panels C & D):** At the family level, **`FAM-001` (Tungipara Sheikh, Serniabat, Chowdhury & Wazed Extended Dynasty)** is unmatched in comparative South Asian politics: across three generations, it has placed **31 unique MPs** into Parliament across **12 of Bangladesh's 13 Parliaments** (1973–2026, absent only in the boycotted Feb 1996 6th Parliament, and represented in the 2026 13th Parliament by BJP Chairman and Cabinet Minister Barrister Andaleeve Rahman Partho in `Bhola-1`), accumulating **102 seat wins** and **64 Cabinet seat-terms** (10.1% of all dynastic seats in the nation's history). Second in breadth is **`FAM-003` (Ershad–Quader Dynasty)** with **13 unique MPs**, **41 seat wins**, and **11 active parliaments**, followed by **`FAM-145` (Raozan Chowdhury Network)** with **6 unique MPs** and **22 seat wins** across 10 parliaments, **`FAM-002` (Majumder–Zia Dynasty)** with **5 unique MPs**, **32 seat wins**, and four premierships, and **`FAM-113` (Narayanganj Osman Dynasty)** with **5 unique MPs** and **13 seat wins** across 8 parliaments.

7.2 Which Constituencies Practice Dynastic Politics the Most? (Question 7)

Table 10 maps the geographic concentration of hereditary politics across Bangladesh, ranking the **Top 15 Dynastic Stronghold Constituencies** from 1973 to 2026.

Table 10: Top 15 Dynastic Stronghold Constituencies in Bangladesh (1973–2026: Single-Family Fiefdoms & Multi-Dynasty Bastions)

Rank	Constituency	Dyn. Wins	Dyn. Share	Parls Dyn.	Archetype	Controlling Dynasties & Succession Trajectory
1	**Sylhet-1**	11 / 13	**84.6%**	11 / 13	Multi-Dynasty Elite Seat	FAM-122 (Humayun Rashid Choudhury), FAM-129 (M. Saifur Rahman), FAM-124 (Muhith & Momen brothers), FAM-125 (Malik & Muktadir father–son in 2026).
2	**Gazipur-2**	10 / 12	**83.3%**	9 / 11	Rival Father–Son Duopoly	FAM-109 (Ahsanullah Master → son Zahid Ahsan Russel, 4 terms) vs. FAM-110 (Minister Prof. M. A. Mannan → son Manjurul Karim Roni in 13th Parl.).
3	**Jhalokati-2**	10 / 12	**83.3%**	9 / 11	Dual-Dynasty Bastion	FAM-001 (Amir Hossain Amu, 5 terms) vs. FAM-067 (Zulfikar Ali Bhutto → widow Israt Sultana Elen Bhutto in 8th & 13th Parls).
4	**Narsingdi-2**	9 / 11	**81.8%**	9 / 11	Father–Son & Brother Seat	FAM-160 (Minister Abdul Momen Khan → son Dr. Abdul Moyeen Khan, 5 terms including 13th) & FAM-112 (Dilip & Zahurul Islam brothers).
5	**Thakurgaon-2**	9 / 11	**81.8%**	9 / 11	Father–Son Left/AL Fiefdom	FAM-017 (7-term MP Md. Dabirul Islam → son Mazharul Islam Suzon in 12th) & FAM-013 (Mirza Ruhul Amin).
6	**Tangail-8**	12 / 15	**80.0%**	10 / 13	Multi-Dynasty Bastion	FAM-076 (Latif Siddiqui & Kader Siddique brothers), FAM-078 (Karatia Panni family), FAM-080 (Shawkat Momen Shahjahan → son Anupam Joy).
7	**Chittagong-6**	10 / 13	**76.9%**	10 / 13	Intra-Clan Rival Stronghold	FAM-140 (Raozan Chowdhury clan: Salahuddin Quader Chowdhury & brother Giasuddin Quader vs. cousin A. B. M. Fazle Karim Chowdhury; 8th–12th).
8	**Pirojpur-2**	9 / 12	**75.0%**	8 / 11	Dual-Dynasty Stronghold	FAM-088 (Anwar Hossain Manju, 7 terms & wife Tasmima Hossain) vs. FAM-070 (Minister Nurul Islam Manzur → son Ahammad Sohel Monzoor in 13th).
9	**Sirajganj-1**	9 / 12	**75.0%**	8 / 11	3-Gen. Single-Family Seat	FAM-006 (PM Capt. M. Mansur Ali → sons Dr. Mohammad Selim & Minister Mohammed Nasim → grandson Tanvir Shakil Joy).
10	**Chittagong-13**	11 / 15	**73.3%**	10 / 13	Dual-Dynasty Bastion	FAM-150 (Akhtaruzzaman Babu, brother Sarwar Jamal Nizam [BNP 6th–8th, 13th] & son Saifuzzaman Jewel [AL 9th–12th]) vs. FAM-151 (Ols Ahmad).
11	**Rangpur-3**	11 / 15	**73.3%**	9 / 13	Single-Family Party HQ	FAM-023 (Pres. H. M. Ershad, wife Rowshan Ershad, brother GM Quader, son Saad Ershad; plus FAM-022/FAM-024).
12	**Gopalganj-2***	8 / 11	**72.7%**	8 / 11	Single-Family Fortress	FAM-001 (Sheikh Fazlul Karim Selim won 8 consecutive times 1986–2024 + *Faridpur-3*) in 1979 = 9/13 Parliaments).
13	**Natore-1**	8 / 11	**72.7%**	8 / 11	Rival Dynastic Duopoly	FAM-037 (Minister Fazlur Rahman Patal → daughter Barrister Farzana Sharmin Putul in 13th) vs. FAM-038 (Momtaz Uddin → widow Shefali & brother Abul Kalam).
14	**Faridpur-2**	10 / 14	**71.4%**	9 / 13	Matriarch vs. Daughter Seat	FAM-115 (Syeda Sajeda Chowdhury → son Shahdab Akbar Labu) vs. FAM-116 (K. M. Obaidur Rahman → daughter Minister Shama Obaed Islam in 13th).
15	**Madaripur-1****	8 / 12	**66.7%**	7 / 11	Father–Son Single-Family	FAM-001 (Ilias Ahmed Chowdhury → son Chief Whip Noor-E-Alam Chowdhury Liton, 7 consecutive terms 1991–2024).

*Note: Other single-family fortresses at 61.5%–66.7% (pooling constituency labels across the 1986 re-delimitation; Sirajganj-2, Lalmonirhat-3, Chittagong-1, and Sirajganj-3 also exceed 66.7%) include **Gopalganj-3** (7/11, Sheikh Hasina FAM-001), **Feni-1** (8/12, Begum Khaleda Zia & brother Sayeed Iskander FAM-002), **Shariatpur-3** (8/12, Abdur Razzaq → son Nahim Razzaq FAM-120), **Sunamganj-2** (8/12, Suranjit Sengupta → widow Dr. Jaya Sengupta FAM-121), and **Bagerhat-1** (8/13, Sheikh Hasina & cousin Sheikh Helal FAM-001).

Table 10 reveals that Bangladesh's top dynastic constituencies fall into two distinct structural archetypes:

1. **Single-Family Hereditary Fortresses:** In constituencies such as `Sirajganj-1` **(Kazipur,** 75.0%**)**, `Rangpur-3` **(Rangpur Sadar,** 73.3%**)**, `Gopalganj-2` **(**72.7% **post-1986 + 1979)**, `Gopalganj-3` **(Tungipara–Kotalipara)**, `Madaripur-1` **(Shibchar,** 66.7%**)**, `Feni-1` **(**66.7%**)**, `Shariatpur-3` **(**66.7%**)**, and `Sunamganj-2` **(**66.7%**)**, a single dominant political family monopolizes the party nomination and general election across two or three consecutive generations. For example, in `Sirajganj-1`, 1975 Prime Minister Captain M. Mansur Ali (`FAM-006`) was succeeded by his eldest son Dr. Mohammad Selim, his younger son Home/Health Minister Mohammed Nasim (6 terms), and his grandson Tanvir Shakil Joy (2 terms).
2. **Rival Multi-Dynasty Duopolies (When Both Major Parties Nominate Dynasts):** Even more revealing are constituencies where dynastic share reaches 80.0% **to** 84.6% because *both* the Awami League and the BNP (or Jatiya Party) nominate rival dynastic families against one another! In `Sylhet-1` **(**84.6%, 11/13 **wins)**, the prestigious Sylhet Sadar seat has rotated almost exclusively among Speaker Humayun Rashid Choudhury (`FAM-122`), Finance Minister M. Saifur Rahman (`FAM-129`), Finance Minister Abul Maal Abdul Muhith and his brother Foreign Minister Dr. A. K. Abdul Momen (`FAM-124`), and BNP MP Khandaker Abdul Malik and his son Khandakar Abdul Muktadir (`FAM-125`, winner in 2026). Similarly, in `Gazipur-2` **(**83.3%**)**, the seat has alternated between the assassinated AL labor leader Ahsanullah Master and his son State Minister Zahid Ahsan Russel (`FAM-109`) versus BNP Minister Prof. M. A. Mannan and his son Manjurul Karim Roni (`FAM-110`, winner in 2026); in `Chittagong-6` **(Raozan,** 76.9%**)**, two rival branches of the exact same extended family (`FAM-145`: Salahuddin and Giasuddin Quader Chowdhury in BNP vs. first cousin A. B. M. Fazle Karim Chowdhury in AL) have held the seat for 10 of 13 parliaments; and in `Faridpur-2` **(**71.4%**)**, AL Deputy Leader Syeda Sajeda Chowdhury and her son Shahdab Akbar Labu (`FAM-115`) have alternated with BNP Secretary General K. M. Obaidur Rahman and his daughter Minister Shama Obaed Islam (`FAM-116`).

8 The "Death-Gate" Mechanism, Cross-Party Insurance, and Gendered Pathways to Power (RQ3 / H2, H4 & H5)

Supporting **Hypothesis 3**, across all $N = 156$ mid-term by-election seat records in the 53-year census, dynastic politicians win 38.46% **(**60/156**)** of mid-term by-elections compared to 21.83% **(**954/4,371**)** in regular general elections ($z = 4.91$, $p < 0.0001$; Online Supplementary Appendix Table A10 enumerates all 35 by-election records whose archival notes explicitly specify the death or assassination of the sitting MP). Forensic tracking of mid-term parliamentary vacancies shows that when a sitting MP dies or is assassinated in office, political parties award the resulting by-election ticket to an immediate family member in **over** 85% **of cases** (Table 11, Panel A). Supporting **Hypothesis 5**, across all 170 political families, 60 **families (**35.29%**)** have placed MPs across two or more distinct political party camps (Table 11, Panel B). Finally, Table 12 confirms **Hypothesis 4 (RQ3)**: across all 81 unique female dynastic MPs, wives and widows (53.1%, 43/81) face a glass ceiling with only a 9.3% **Cabinet appointment rate**, whereas patrilineal daughters and granddaughters (38.3%, 31/81) achieve a 35.5% **Cabinet appointment rate** (3.81× higher; two-proportion z-test $p = 0.0051$, Fisher's exact test $p = 0.0082$—a divergence that remains statistically significant at $\hat{\beta}_{\text{Daughter}} = +0.1902^{**}$, SE $= 0.0787$, $t = 2.42$, $p = 0.018$ when controlling for mid-term by-election entry, direct general-seat election, and career terms served, or 32.4% vs. 12.5% when excluding by-election-only entrants), and women who use Reserved Women's Seats as an incubator to transition into General Seats ($n = 13$) achieve a 53.8% **Cabinet appointment rate**. Finally, the August 2024 revolution and subsequent barring of the Awami League from the February 2026 13th Parliament provide a sharp out-of-sample natural experiment for our correlated-shock kinship insurance model (Equation 2 and Appendix G Proposition 1): among the 86 political dynasties that held Awami League parliamentary seats during the 2014–2024 dominant-party era (10th–12th Parliaments), 0.0% **(**0/75**) of single-bloc AL dynasties survived into the 13th Parliament**, whereas 45.5% **(**5/11**, Fisher's exact** $p = 0.000013$**;** 23.8% **[**5/21, $p = 0.00058$**] across all multi-party labels)** of cross-bloc diversified families retained parliamentary representation in 2026 through their BNP, BJP, or Independent wings.

Table 11: Landmark "Death-Gate" Mid-Term By-Election Successions and Cross-Party Kinship Insurance Networks

Panel A: Landmark Verified "Death-Gate" Mid-Term By-Election Familial Successions					
Constituency (`Family_ID`)	**Deceased Incumbent MP**	**Year**	**Dynastic Successor**	**Kinship Relation**	**By-Election & Career Trajectory**
Madaripur-1 (`FAM-001`)	Ilias Ahmed Chowdhury	1991	Noor-E-Alam Chowdhury Liton	Eldest Son	Won 5th Parl. By-Election; served 7 terms & Chief Whip
Faridpur-4 (`FAM-119`)	Mosharraf Hossain	1999	Begum Saleha Mosharraf	Widow (Wife)	Won 7th Parl. By-Election (1999) & 9th Parl. Reserved Seat
Gazipur-2 (`FAM-109`)	Ahsanullah Master (Assassinated)	2004	Zahid Ahsan Russel	Eldest Son	Won 8th Parl. By-Election; served 4 terms & State Minister
Shariatpur-3 (`FAM-120`)	Abdur Razzaq	2011	Nahim Razzaq	Eldest Son	Won 9th Parl. By-Election (2012); served 3 consecutive terms
Barisal-5 (`FAM-064`)	Shawkat Hossain Hiron	2014	Begum Jebunnesa Afroz	Widow (Wife)	Won 10th Parl. By-Election (June 2014)
Narayanganj-5 (`FAM-113`)	A. K. M. Nasim Osman	2014	A. K. M. Salim Osman	Younger Brother	Won 10th Parl. By-Election; held seat through 12th Parl.
Sunamganj-2 (`FAM-121`)	Suranjit Sengupta	2017	Dr. Joya Sengupta	Widow (Wife)	Won 10th Parl. By-Election; re-elected in 11th & 12th
Sirajganj-1 (`FAM-006`)	Mohammed Nasim (COVID-19)	2020	Tanvir Shakil Joy	Son (3rd Gen.)	Won 11th Parl. By-Election (2020) & 12th Parliament
Faridpur-2 (`FAM-116`)	Syeda Sajeda Chowdhury	2022	Shahdab Akbar Chowdhury Labu	Younger Son	Won 11th Parl. By-Election (Nov 2022)
Panel B: Major Cross-Party Kinship Insurance Networks Bridging Rival Political Camps (60/170 **Multi-Party Families**)					
`FAM-001` (Sheikh Network)	Core AL dynasty (Mujib, Hasina, Selim), bridged via marriage to JP Minister **Naziur Rahman Manzur**, BJP Chairman & 2026 Minister **Andaleeve Rahman Partho**, JP Minister **Sheikh Shahidul Islam**, WP MP **Sheikh Hafizur Rahman**, and co-in-law ties to BNP Minister **Iqbal Hasan Mahmud Tuku**.				
`FAM-003` (Ershad–Quader)	Core JP dynasty (Ershad, Rowshan, GM Quader), bridged via maternal uncle **Riaz Uddin Ahmed Bhola Miah** (**AL** in 1st, **BNP** in 2nd, **JP** Minister in 4th–5th) and **Dr. Asadur Rahman** (AL).				
`FAM-145` (Raozan Chowdhury)	Spans ML, BNP, JP, NDP, and AL: **Salahuddin Quader** (ML/NDP/JP/BNP, 2nd–8th), **Giasuddin Quader** (BNP), **Hummam Quader** (BNP, 13th) vs. cousin **Fazle Karim Chowdhury** (AL, 8th–12th) and affinal kinsmen **Salman F. Rahman** & **Saber Hossain Chowdhury** (AL Ministers).				
`FAM-159` (Jabbar Khan)	**Rashed Khan Menon** (Workers Party President & AL-allied Minister, 2nd, 5th, 9th–12th) & wife **Lutfun Nesa Khan** alongside sister **Begum Selima Rahman** (BNP Standing Committee & Minister, 5th, 6th, 8th, 13th).				
`FAM-150` (Anwara Chowdhury)	**Akhtaruzzaman Chowdhury Babu** (AL) & Land Minister **Saifuzzaman Chowdhury Javed** (AL, 9th–12th) alongside brother **Sarwar Jamal Nizam** (BNP, 6th–8th, 13th).				

Table 12: Gendered Pathways to Parliamentary and Executive Power Among Dynastic MPs ($N = 401$ Unique Profiles, 1973–2026)

Gender & Kinship Entry Pathway	**Unique MPs (n)**	**Share of Group**	**General Seat MPs**	**Reserved Seat Only**	**Ever in Cabinet (n)**	**Cabinet Rate (%)**
A. All Female Dynastic MPs by Kinship Pathway ($n = 81$)						
1. Spousal / Widow Succession (Wife or Widow of MP/Leader)	43	53.1%	27 (62.8%)	16 (37.2%)	4	**9.3%**
2. Patrilineal Inheritance (Daughter / Granddaughter of MP/Leader)	31	38.3%	13 (41.9%)	18 (58.1%)	11	**35.5%**
3. Sibling / Extended / Affinal Network (Sister, Aunt, In-Law)	7	8.6%	6 (85.7%)	1 (14.3%)	4	**57.1%**
B. All Female Dynastic MPs by Seat Trajectory ($n = 81$)						
1. Directly Elected General Seat Only	33	40.7%	33	0	10	30.3%
2. Reserved Women's Seat Only	35	43.2%	0	35	2	**5.7%**
3. Incubator Transition (Served in Both Reserved & General Seats)	13	16.0%	13	0	7	**53.8%**
C. Gender & Seat-Type Benchmarks ($N = 401$ Profiles; 464 Reserved Seats)						
All Unique Female Dynastic MPs (Mean Terms = 2.25)	81	20.2% of Dyn.	46 (56.8%)	35 (43.2%)	19	23.5%
All Unique Male Dynastic MPs (Mean Terms = 2.60)	320	79.8% of Dyn.	320 (100.0%)	0 (0.0%)	148	**46.3%**
All Unique Dynastic MPs Combined (Mean Terms = 2.53)	401	100.0% of Dyn.	366 (91.3%)	35 (8.7%)	167	**41.6%**
Reserved Women's Seat Records: Dynastic ($n = 65$ seat-terms)	—	14.0% of Res.	—	65	16 seat-terms	**24.6%**
Reserved Women's Seat Records: Non-Dynastic ($n = 399$ seat-terms)	—	86.0% of Res.	—	399	33 seat-terms	**8.3%**

Figure 4: Generational Turnover (Table 4) and the Gendered Bifurcation Across Female Dynastic Entry Pathways (Table 12)

Panel A: Generational Crossover — 1st-Generation Founders vs. 2nd/3rd-Generation Dynastic Heirs (Exact Match to Table 4)

Milestone Parliament	1st-Gen Founders Bar	1st-Gen % (n)	2nd/3rd-Gen Heirs Bar	2nd+3rd-Gen % (n)
1st Parliament (1973, $n = 54$)		90.7% (49)		9.3% (5)
5th Parliament (1991, $n = 87$)		74.7% (65)		25.3% (22)
8th Parliament (2001, $n = 108$)		61.1% (66)		38.9% (42)
9th Parliament (2009, $n = 98$)		54.1% (53)		45.9% (45)
10th Parliament (2014 Crossover, $n = 102$)		43.1% (44)		**56.9%** (58)
11th Parliament (2019, $n = 115$)		33.0% (38)		**67.0%** (77)
12th Parliament (2024 Peak, $n = 83$)		18.1% (15)		**81.9%** (68)
13th Parliament (2026 Post-Rev., $n = 54$)		18.5% (10)		**81.5%** (44)

Panel B: Executive Cabinet Conversion Across Female Dynastic Entry Pathways (Exact Match to Table 12, $N = 81$)

Female Dynastic Pathway	Share of Female Dynasts	Subgroup Breakdown	Cabinet Conversion Bar	Cabinet Rate (%)
1. Spousal / Widow Succession ($n = 43$)	53.1% (43/81)	27 Gen. / 16 Res.-Only		**9.3%** (4/43)
2. Patrilineal Daughters / Granddaughters ($n = 31$)	38.3% (31/81)	13 Gen. / 18 Res.-Only		**35.5%** (11/31, 3.81×)
B1. Directly Elected General Seat Only ($n = 33$)	40.7% (33/81)	33 General / 0 Reserved		**30.3%** (10/33)
B2. Reserved Women's Seat Only ($n = 35$)	43.2% (35/81)	0 General / 35 Reserved		**5.7%** (2/35)
B3. Incubator Springboard (Both Res. & Gen., $n = 13$)	16.0% (13/81)	13 Transitioned to Gen.		**53.8%** (7/13)

Notes: Daughter vs. Widow z-test $p = 0.0051$, Fisher's exact $p = 0.0082$; controlling for mid-term by-election entry, general-seat election, and terms served ($n = 74$) yields $\hat{\beta}_{\text{Daughter}} = +0.1902^{**}$ (SE $= 0.0787$, $t = 2.42$, $p = 0.018$).

9 Discussion, Mixed-Methods Survey Extension, and Policy Implications for Democratic Reform

9.1 Theoretical Synthesis: From Legislative Entry to Executive Gatekeeping

The empirical evidence assembled in this study across all 13 parliaments of Bangladesh (1973–2026) compels a fundamental revision of how comparative political science conceptualizes hereditary rule in developing democracies. Whereas existing quantitative literature treats political dynasties primarily as an *electoral recruitment phenomenon* driven by local name recognition and incumbency advantage [17, 50, 56], our full-census econometric models demonstrate that the steepest dynastic distortion occurs **inside the executive branch**. Even when comparing two parliamentarians from the exact same political party, sitting in the exact same parliament, holding the exact same type of seat, and possessing the exact same cumulative parliamentary seniority, a dynastic MP is $+24.57$ **percentage points more likely to be appointed to the Cabinet** ($p < 0.0001$), $+25.86$ **percentage points more likely to be appointed a Full Cabinet Minister**, and $+18.91$ **percentage points more likely to control a high-rent sovereign portfolio**.

Even more tellingly, this executive gatekeeping premium is most pronounced at the point of initial entry: first-term dynastic freshmen are fast-tracked into Full Cabinet Ministries at $3.88\times$ **the rate of non-dynastic freshmen** (29.58% vs. 7.63%), effectively allowing family bloodlines to substitute for three full terms of legislative service. Furthermore, our regime-cycle analysis demonstrates why authoritarian interludes and revolutionary upheavals fail to eradicate dynastic power: military rulers (1979–1990) relied on co-opted dynastic ministers (33.95% of military-era Cabinets) to compensate for their lack of grassroots party legitimacy; competitive democratic elections (1991–2008) triggered a massive escalation in dynastic seat share (24.7%–30.7%) due to campaign financing and local brokerage demands; and 35.29% of political families systematically hedge regime risk by placing kinsmen across rival party camps (`FAM-001`, `FAM-003`, `FAM-145`, `FAM-150`, `FAM-159`).

9.2 Mixed-Methods Field Survey Extension and Institutional Reform Implications

To complement our macro-historical census with micro-behavioral data in follow-up field research, we pair this database with a four-module survey instrument targeting parliamentarians, constituency nomination boards, and voters: (1) *Module A (Candidate Political Socialization & Brokerage Inheritance)*, measuring the transfer of campaign financiers, union parishad chairmen, and ward enforcement networks from parent/spouse to heir; (2) *Module B (Nomination Board Bargaining & Factional Peacekeeping)*, testing whether central party leaders nominate "death-gate" widows and sons primarily to prevent violent local sub-factional defections; (3) *Module C (Executive Access & Patronage Allocation)*, measuring frequency of direct Prime Ministerial access and constituency infrastructure allocations (*TR/Kabita* and ADP block grants); and (4) *Module D (Citizen Evaluations of Dynastic Khomota)*,

testing whether voters rationally prefer dynastic heirs because they anticipate higher ministerial bargaining power in Dhaka.

Finally, our findings carry direct constitutional and policy implications for democratic institutional design in post-2024 Bangladesh and across South Asia. As Bangladesh debates constitutional and electoral reforms under the 13th Parliament, three institutional interventions are essential to break the executive gatekeeping cartel: (i) **democratizing candidate selection** through binding, secret-ballot constituency party primaries to dismantle central nomination-board gatekeeping [4, 15]; (ii) **reforming the Reserved Women's Seat quota** by replacing indirect party-list co-optation (which peaked at 26.0% dynastic capture in the 11th Parliament) with direct, rotational constituency elections and a strict one-term incubator limit for close relatives of sitting or former MPs; and (iii) **instituting parliamentary seniority and conflict-of-interest norms for sovereign Cabinet ministries**, requiring backbench committee apprenticeship prior to full ministerial appointment so that executive power is anchored in legislative accountability rather than hereditary lineage.

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